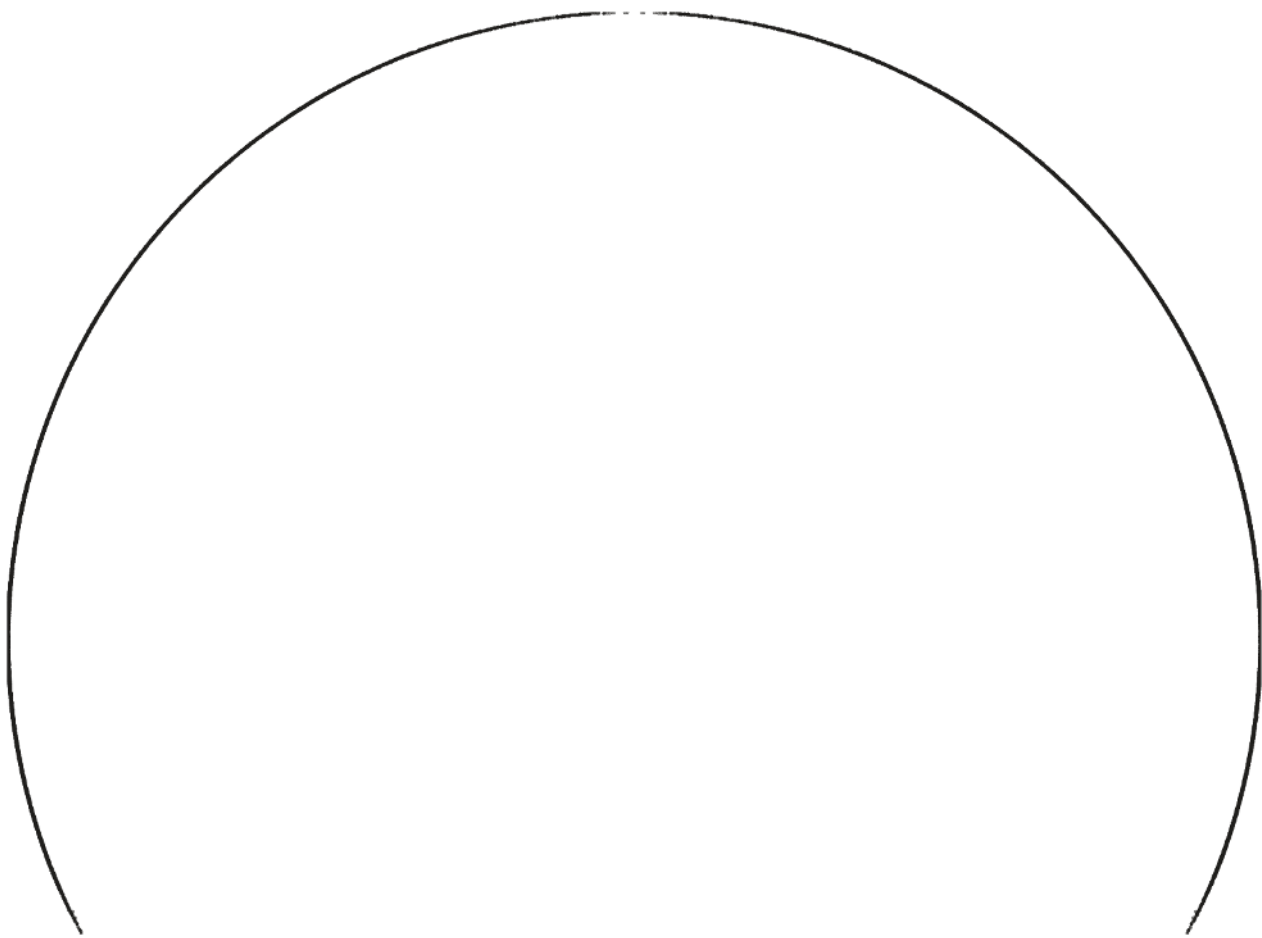


REF01 - Zeiss reference sphere

An Exploration of Precision



Author: Stine Gerdes, arcsai.org

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Date: 2025-08-02

Version: 01.20



Max Fomitchev-Zamilov

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Artifact Information

Artifact Data

Collection
Provenance¹
Provenience²
Attribution

Art dealer information

Ref.
Description Zeiss 1.00000 inch reference sphere
URL

Maijers vessel classification³

Short classification Classification not set on object
Long classification Classification not set on object

Physical properties

Precision score⁴ 43 943
Height (approximate) 25.4 mm 1.00 in
Width (approximate) 25.4 mm 1.00 in
Material
Mohs Hardness⁵ Unknown (Unknown)
Weight

Scan information

Source Scan recieved by Max Fomitchev-Zamilov
Source file name ref-sphere-lo.stl
Scan method CMM
Scanner Keyence VL -500
Rated scan accuracy 10 µm | 0.41 thou
Scan date 2025
Scanned by Max Fomitchev-Zamilov

Mesh decimation None, raw scan file used in the analysis
Number of vertices 12 201
Mesh density⁶ 271 µm | 10.66 thou
Max vertex distance 568 µm | 22.364 thou
Min vertex distance 43 µm | 1.683 thou
Vertices per cm² 1103 (approximated)
Vertices per in² 7116 (approximated)

¹The verifiable chain of custody of an artifact

²The location or site where an artifact was recovered

³Vessel artifact classification developed by W. Arnold Maijer and described in his publication Masters of Stone, ISBN 978-90-829212-0-5

⁴The precision score metric is described in Precision Score Of The Artifact, p. 32

⁵The Mohs scale is an ordinal scale, from 1 to 10, describing the materials resistance to abrasion (the ability of harder material to scratch softer material)

⁶Median distance between vertices

Alignment In The Cartesian Coordinate System

For precise and valid measurements of the vessel's geometry to be possible, the points of the scanned dataset must first and foremost be placed optimally in a Cartesian coordinate system. Several alignment methods and algorithms have been tested on a number of different vessels to determine the best way to achieve optimal alignment.

Any misalignment of the artifact will increase the error of the precision measurements, due to the distortion/wobble effect caused by the misaligned object. To visualize this distortion, we can consider a representation of the three-dimensional point cloud data, folded to a two-dimensional plane. This folded representation is obtained by rotating all scanned points around an assumed center axis to $y = 0, x > 0$, thus resulting in a two-dimensional profile representation of all scanned vertices in the object.

Figure 1 illustrates this effect on a ideal ellipsoid. In the first image, the ellipsoid is perfectly aligned, resulting in a narrow and precise two-dimensional folded profile. As misalignments are introduced, the two-dimensional profile increases in width, visually showing the distortion, causing the error in the precision measurements to increase. While easy to understand visually, this distortion can also be objectively quantified, and as such used to compare the fitness of different assumed center axes against each other, and further to create an automated and solid process for optimal Cartesian alignment of the scan data.

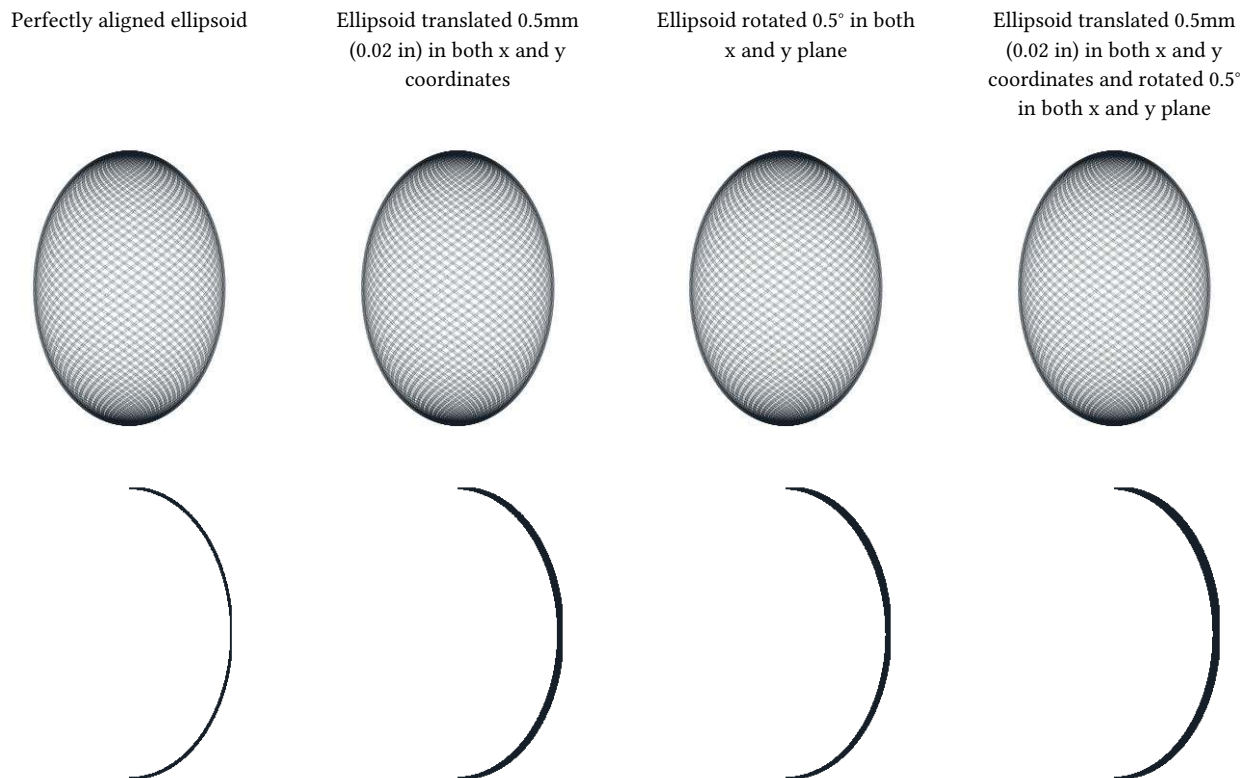


Figure 1: Distortion caused by a misalignment of the artifact

In contemporary metrology analysis of modern production objects, it is common to align the object in a Cartesian coordinate system by fitting a flat surface of the object to a reference plane in the coordinate system, cylindrical features to an ideal cylinder etc., or by using specific markers placed on the object in the design process. This methodology, however, is inadequate for the ancient objects in question. Most scanned artifacts, do not have a valid flat surface which could be aligned to a plane in the Cartesian coordinate system; most surfaces seem to be curved. Some artifacts do have a flat base, however this is often a worn area of the artifact and practical tests have shown that alignment to such surfaces will not produce optimal alignment of the scan data.

As conventional methods of alignment do not always yield good results with these types of artifacts, a more adequate method of alignment has been developed to enable precise measurements and statistical analysis of the scan data.

To find the optimal position of the vessel in the coordinate system, a range of rotation and translation tests are carried out to find the best fit of the central axis.

Based on the assumption that the analyzed object was created using a rotational process, and thus have symmetry around a central axis, the alignment of the artifact is carried out in a two-step process. An overview of this process is given below.

The artifact is placed in a Cartesian coordinate system, in an initially unaligned state. The first step in the alignment process estimates the central rotational axis of the vessel, by analyzing the coaxiality of thin cross-section slices of the vessel. The slices will be as thin as possible based on the mesh density of the scan, while still ensuring enough data points in each slice to be statistically valid.

For each slice, circular regression⁷ (estimate of best fit circle) is used to estimate the center point of this slice. Combined over the total Z-axis range of the vessel, these center points provide us with an indicator of the incline and position of the vessel's central axis.

The next step will optimize the center axis alignment by progressively minimizing the deviation (perpendicular to the surface curvature) of the two-dimensional profile, see Figure 1. By ascertaining and comparing the resulting fit of many thousands of different potential rotations, the best fit alignment of the scan data can be estimated, and an optimal center axis (in relation to the data points) can be reconstructed. The actual three-dimensional point-cloud is then aligned to this axis, by rotating and translating the scanned data points to match the Z-axis of the Cartesian coordinate system.

To enable extensive analysis of the full surface of the artifact, the mesh is split into exterior and interior surfaces. The exterior surface is aligned independently of interior data points, providing a baseline for exterior quality assessment. The interior surface is represented by two alignments:

- Aligned with the exterior mesh to analyze concentricity, and
- Aligned separately to assess its precision and compare the true tilt/displacement between interior and exterior surfaces.

⁷Circle regression algorithm used: Kenichi Kanatani, Prasanna Rangarajan, "Hyper least squares fitting of circles and ellipses" Computational Statistics & Data Analysis, Vol. 55, pages 2197-2208, (2011)

Statistics used throughout the report

This section provides an overview of the key statistical and model-evaluation metrics employed throughout the report to analyze dataset variability, model fit, and predictive accuracy.

Each measure is introduced with its mathematical formulation, practical interpretation, and explicit reference to how it is calculated in the context of the evaluated models and residuals. Together, these metrics quantify:

- Data variability (e.g., MAD, Standard Deviation, Range).
- Model accuracy (e.g., MSD, RMSD).
- Robustness vs. sensitivity to extreme values and central tendencies.

Mean Squared Deviation (MSD), also known as Mean Squared Error (MSE).

$$\text{MSD} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n (y_i - \hat{y})^2}{n}$$

The Mean Squared Deviation (MSD) measures the average magnitude of squared differences between observed (y_i) and predicted ($\hat{y}$) values, calculated as the mean of squared residuals, and is used as a measure of discrepancy in regression and model-fitting contexts.

This measure amplifies the influence of larger deviations through squaring, emphasizes imperfections in the observed data, but retains sensitivity to outliers.

Root Mean Squared Deviation (RMSD), also known as Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE).

$$\text{RMSD} = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_{i=1}^n (y_i - \hat{y})^2}{n}}$$

The Root Mean Square Deviation (RMSD) measures the magnitude of differences between observed (y_i) and predicted ($\hat{y}$) values by calculating the square root of the average of squared residuals.

RMSD is a commonly used measure of discrepancy in regression and model-fitting contexts. It quantifies the average magnitude of residuals while retaining sensitivity to larger deviations (via squaring), making it particularly useful for evaluating model accuracy.

Standard Deviation (SD)

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_{i=1}^n (y_i - \bar{y})^2}{n - 1}}$$

The Standard Deviation measures the spread of data (y_i) around the mean ($\bar{y}$) by calculating the square root of the average of squared differences between each value and the mean.

It is sensitive to outliers as it amplifies their influence through squaring, in contrast to MAD.

Throughout this report, the Standard Deviation is calculated using the absolute residuals from regression models.

Median Absolute Deviation (MedianAD)

$$\text{MedianAD} = \text{median}(|y_i - \text{median}(y)|)$$

The Median Absolute Deviation (MAD) measures the spread of data around the median by calculating the median of absolute differences between each value and the median.

MAD is a robust measure of spread, analogous to the interquartile range (a robust measure centered on the middle 50% of data), and differs from the standard deviation in that it minimizes the impact of outliers.

Throughout this report, the MAD is calculated using the absolute values of residuals from regression models.

Range

$$\max(y_i) - \min(y_i)$$

The Range measures the spread of a dataset by calculating the difference between the maximum and minimum values.

The Range is a simple measure of spread, capturing the full extent of variability. Range is very sensitive to extreme values, as it is entirely determined by the two most extreme data points.

Throughout this report, the Range is calculated using the full range of residuals from regression models.

Precision

To explore the manufacturing precision of the artifact in depth, the following analysis have been carried out:

- Circularity around the axis of symmetry is examined in detail at selected cross-sections.
- Overall circularity around the axis of symmetry is measured for the full height of the vessel (areas of the vessel with extensive damage are not taken into account for this metric).
- Concentricity of the vessel between selected cross-sections are examined in detail to determine if the existence of an axis of rotation in the manufacture of the object can be established.
- The coaxiality of the vessel is analyzed to explore the precision of the central axis of the object.
- The surface variability is analyzed and visualized on through a heatmap.

Circularity

Circularity is the measurement of how round the surface of an object is, optionally in reference to a datum axis. The *circularity tolerance* is the radial distance of two circles, each with their centers in the datum axis, and each of them conforming, respectively, to the minimum and maximum deviations of the data-set to a true circle, see Figure 2.

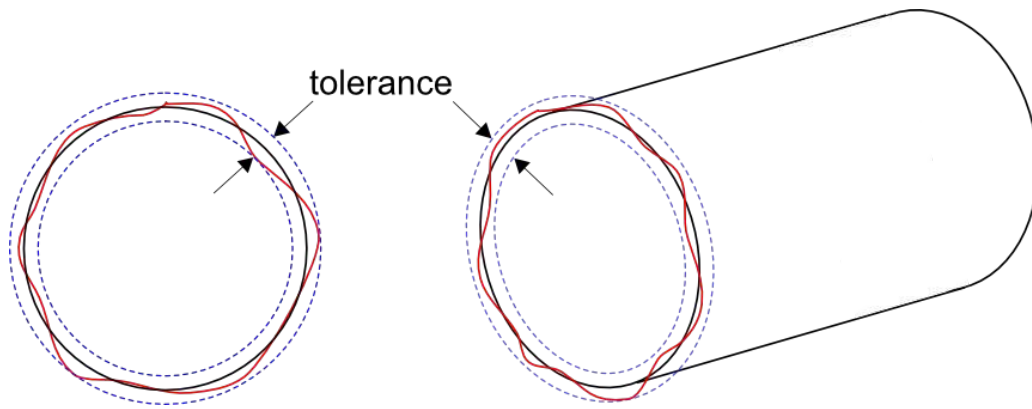


Figure 2: Circularity tolerance.

Circularity is examined at different cross-sections of the vessel, using the established Z-axis as the datum axis (axis of symmetry). The distance between the scanned points in the local datum plane is measured to determine the range between the two concentric circles encompassing the measured points, see Figure 3.

Referencing all of the individual circularity measurements to the global (reconstructed) axis of symmetry of the object, allows us to ascertain not only circularity of local features of the object, but how well circularity was *maintained* over the entire manufacturing process. This is an important distinction, which may be able to provide valuable insights into requirements of the construction methods. For reference, and seeing that the variance in local circularity also holds interest, measurements of circularity of the vessel without reference to the axis of symmetry can additionally be found in the Concentricity, p. 19.

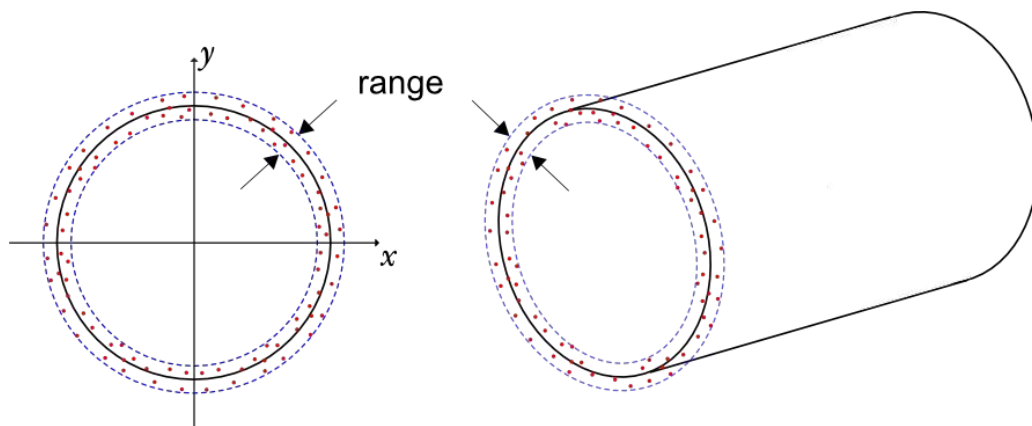


Figure 3: Circularity measurements.

If the circularity is determined from slices of the vessel exclusively in the *Z-plane* (actually measuring the cylindricity of a very thin slices of the vessel, in an attempt to approximate circularity), this would - in some areas - introduce significant distortion (increasing measurement errors) in the samples, due to the curvature of the vessel's surface.

Each sample slice of the vessel is therefore obtained perpendicular to the surface curvature, see Figure 5 to Figure 9. The measurements are taken conservatively without filtration of potential outliers.

To explore the potential distortion caused by obtaining samples in the Z-plane only, please refer to Appendix A, where measurements in the Z-plane and measurements perpendicular to surface curvature are compared side by side.

Detailed circularity measurements of selected points

Circularity measurements across a range of selected slices of the vessel (see Table 1) have been analyzed in-depth, and detailed plots of each measurement is provided. Furthermore, full circularity measurements are shown for each available scanned surface including a detailed plot to visualize the circularity of all areas of the vessel.

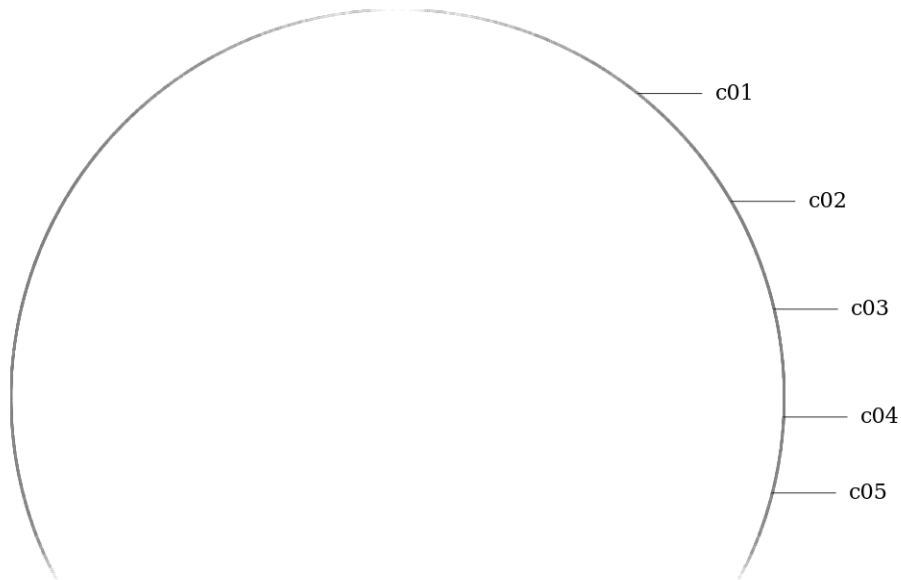


Figure 4: Circularity measurement sample locations, full mesh aligned with exterior surface

Metric

Tag	Area	Measured deviation ⁸	Residuals				Sam-ple size	Slice		
			Range	RMSD ⁹	MAD ¹⁰	SD		Height	Z coord.	Radius ¹¹
		mm	mm	mm	mm	mm		mm	mm	mm
c01	full	Ø15.826±0.014	0.022	0.005	0.002	0.003	44	0.200	15.254	7.913
c02	full	Ø21.944±0.010	0.020	0.004	0.002	0.002	121	0.200	11.716	10.972
c03	full	Ø24.753±0.011	0.020	0.004	0.001	0.002	157	0.200	8.178	12.376
c04	full	Ø25.374±0.013	0.022	0.005	0.002	0.003	139	0.200	4.640	12.687
c05	full	Ø24.619±0.015	0.027	0.006	0.003	0.004	116	0.200	2.148	12.310

Imperial

Tag	Area	Measured deviation ⁸	Residuals				Sam-ple size	Slice		
			Range	RMSD ⁹	MAD ¹⁰	SD		Height	Z coord.	Radius ¹¹
		in	in	in	in	in		in	in	in
c01	full	Ø0.6231±0.0006	0.0009	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	44	0.0079	0.6005	0.3115
c02	full	Ø0.8639±0.0004	0.0008	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	121	0.0079	0.4613	0.4320
c03	full	Ø0.9745±0.0004	0.0008	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	157	0.0079	0.3220	0.4873
c04	full	Ø0.9990±0.0005	0.0009	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	139	0.0079	0.1827	0.4995
c05	full	Ø0.9693±0.0006	0.0010	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	116	0.0079	0.0846	0.4846

Table 1: Detailed circularity measurements at selected samples of REF01.

Figure 5 to Figure 9 shows a detailed plots of each circularity measurement.

⁸Sample diameter Ø± maximum measured deviation from measured radius

⁹Root mean square deviation (RMSD) also called Root mean square error (RMSE)

¹⁰Median absolute deviation

¹¹Median sample radius from z-axis

Graphical overview of circularity measurement c01

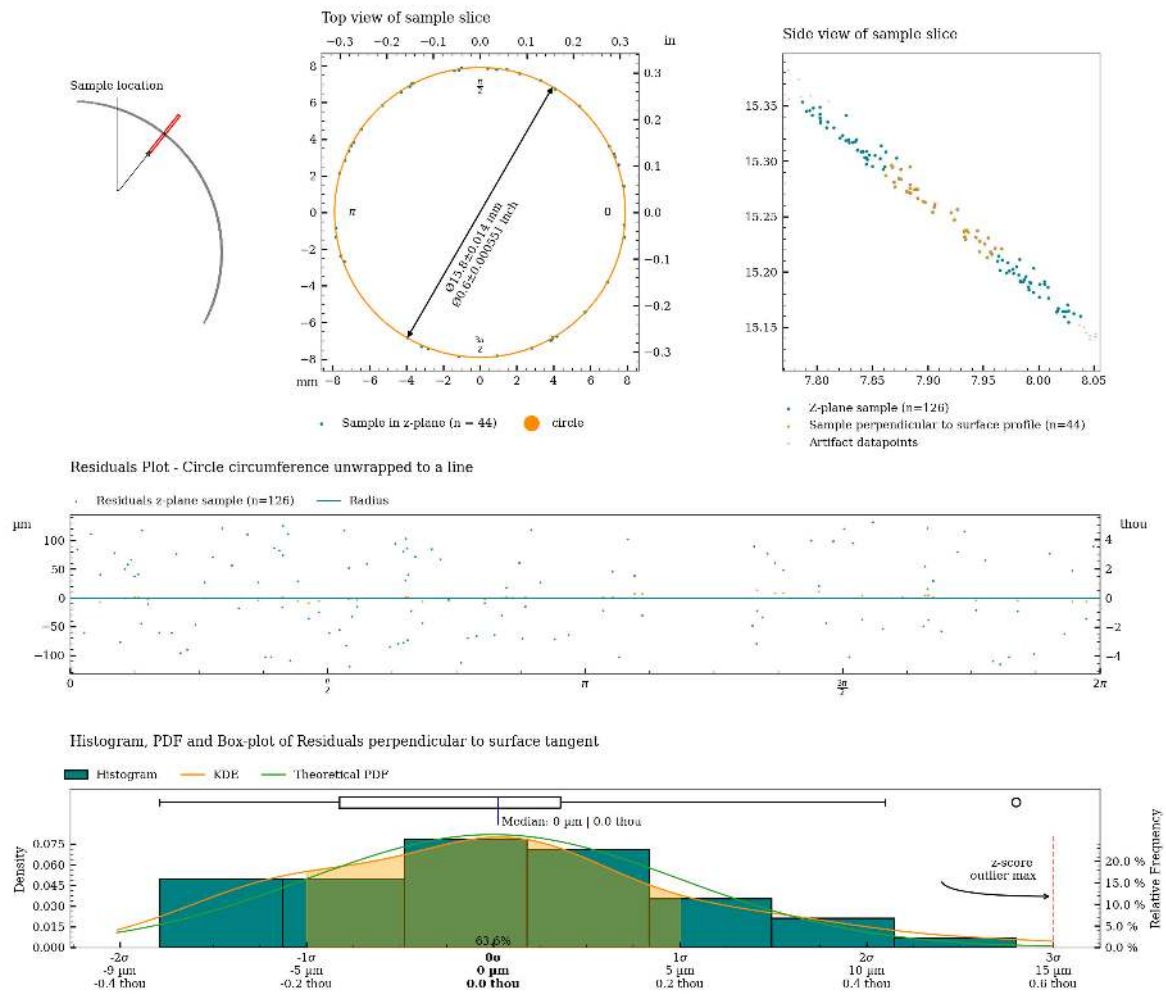


Figure 5: Charts with statistics for the measurement of c01.

Graphical overview of circularity measurement c02

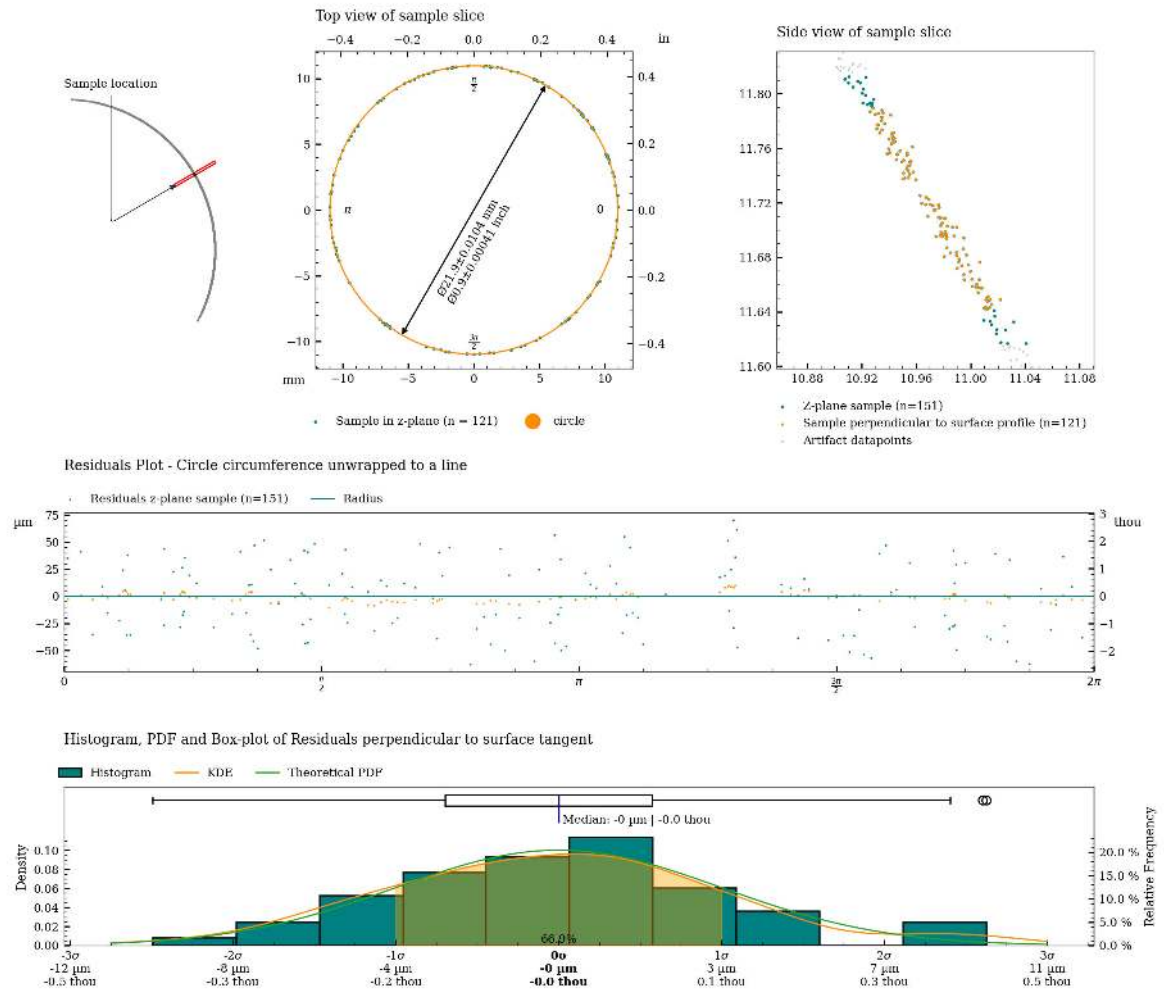


Figure 6: Charts with statistics for the measurement of c02.

Graphical overview of circularity measurement c03

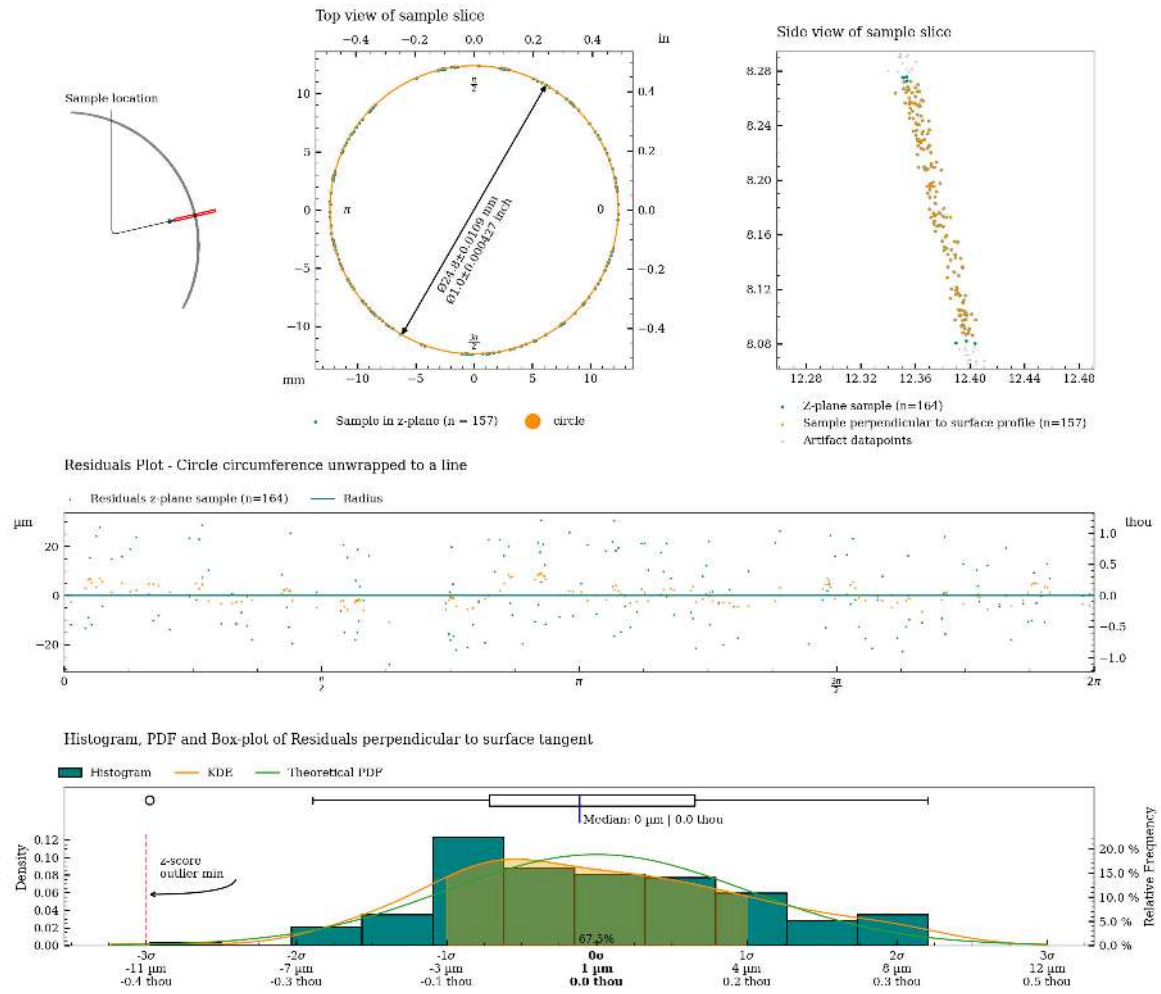


Figure 7: Charts with statistics for the measurement of c03.

Graphical overview of circularity measurement c04

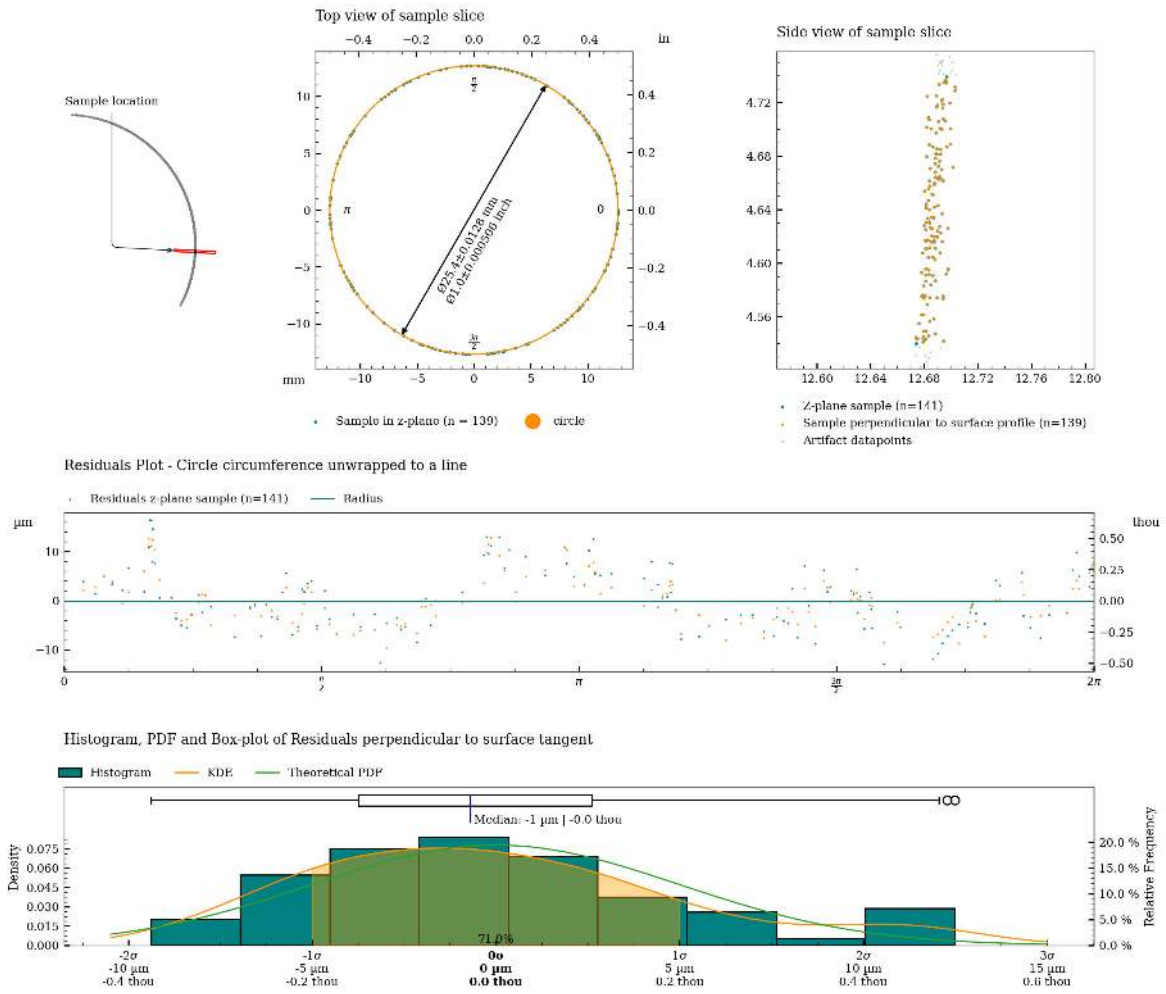


Figure 8: Charts with statistics for the measurement of c04.

Graphical overview of circularity measurement c05

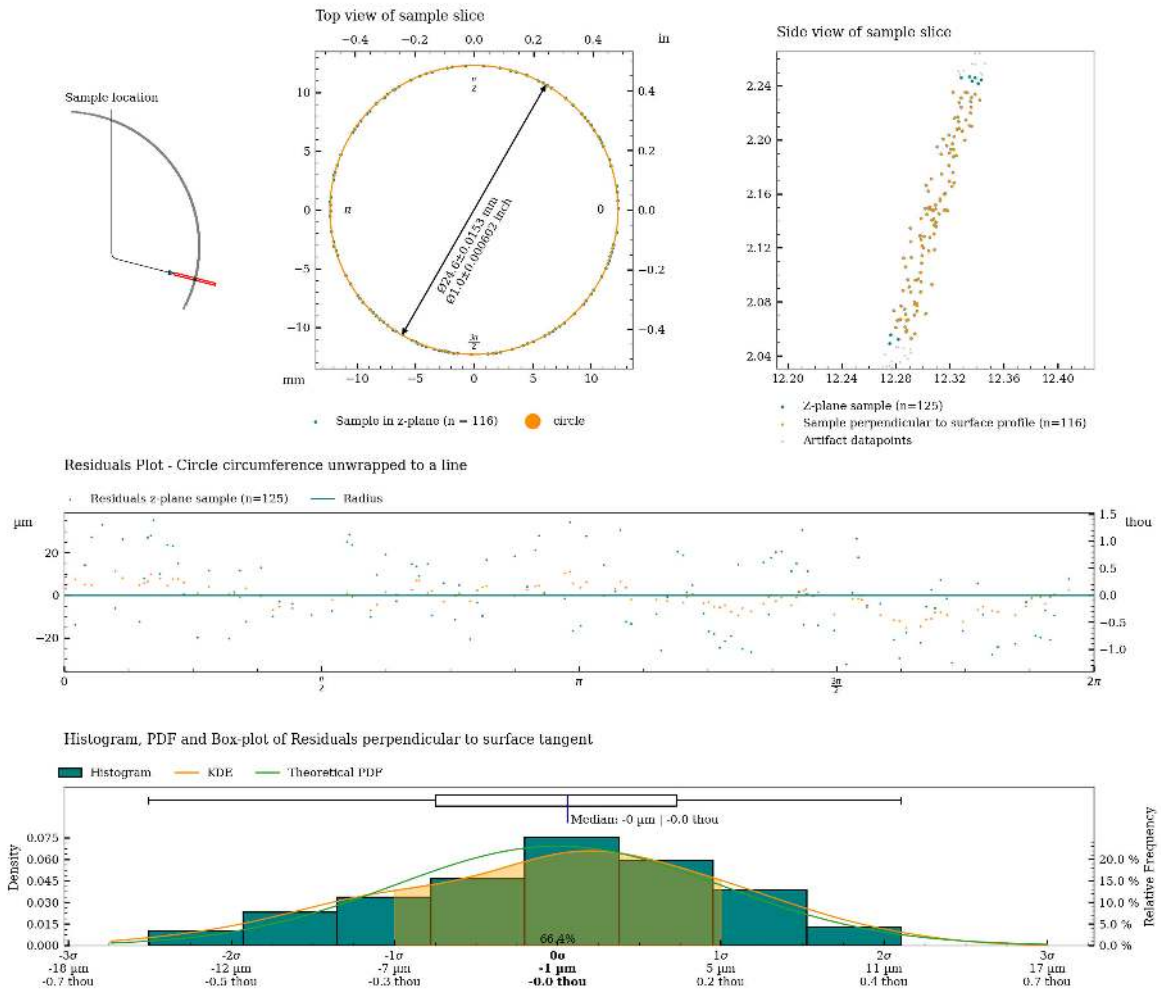


Figure 9: Charts with statistics for the measurement of c05.

Table 2 shows statistical measures of the circularity of the vessel, measured along the full height (areas on the artifact scan containing damaged parts have been removed to the best extent possible to reduce the influence of the measurement).

Metric											
Area	Range			Standard Deviation			RMSD			Slices	Slice height
	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.		
	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm		
REF01	0.022	0.018	0.033	0.003	0.002	0.004	0.005	0.004	0.006	54	0.200

Imperial											
Area	Range			Standard Deviation			RMSD			Slices	Slice height
	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.		
	in	in	in	in	in	in	in	in	in		
REF01	0.022	0.018	0.033	0.003	0.002	0.004	0.005	0.004	0.006	54	0.200

Table 2: Perpendicular Circularity analysis of REF01.

Circularity analysis of REF01 surface

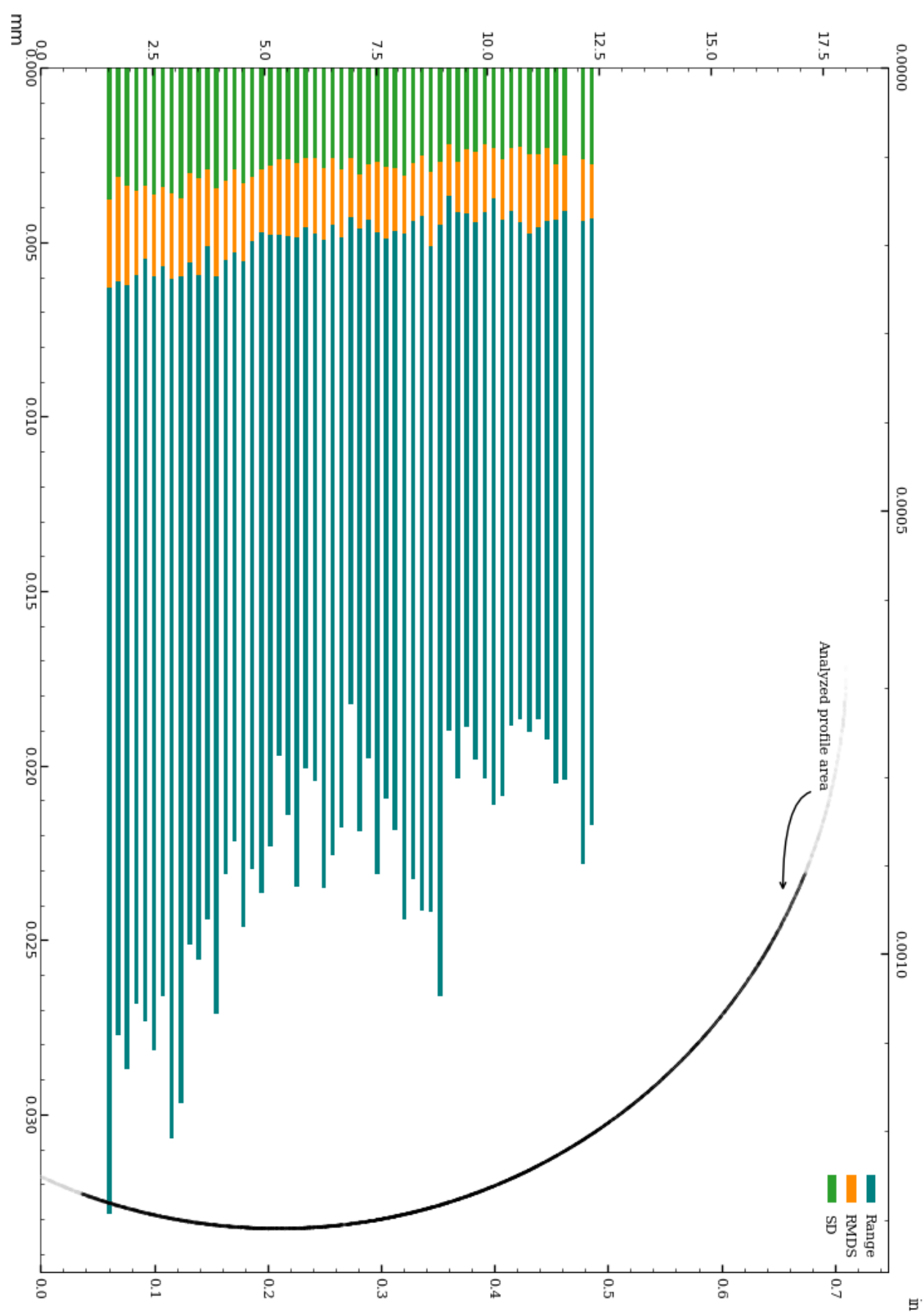


Figure 10: Circularity of REF01 surface.

Circularity analysis of REF01 surface, Standard Deviation and Root Mean Squared Deviation

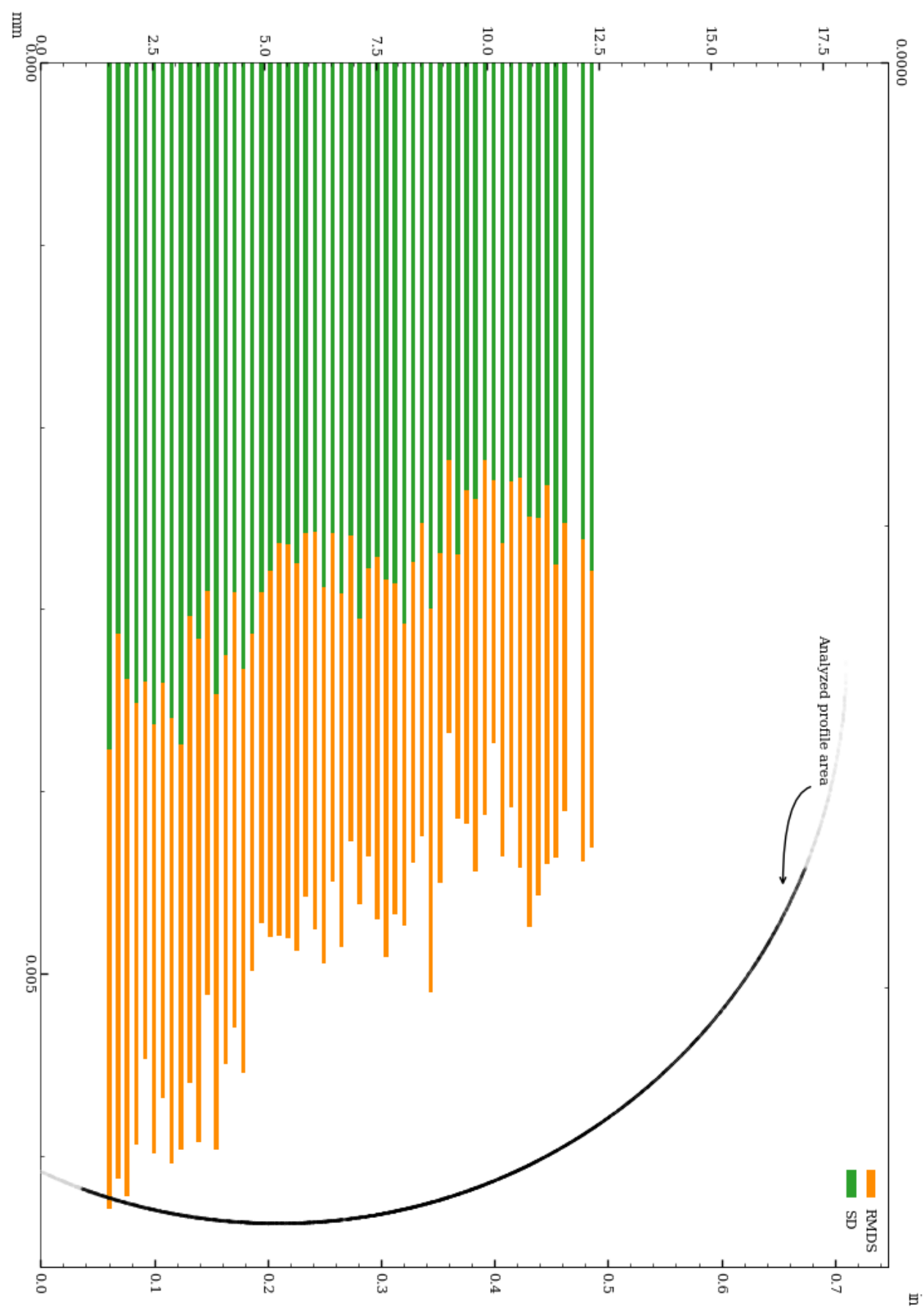


Figure 11: Vessel circularity of REF01 surface, standard deviation and median absolute deviation.

The distributions of the circularity measurements across 54 slices of the REF01 surface are shown below.

Range measurement distribution across 54 slices of REF01 surface

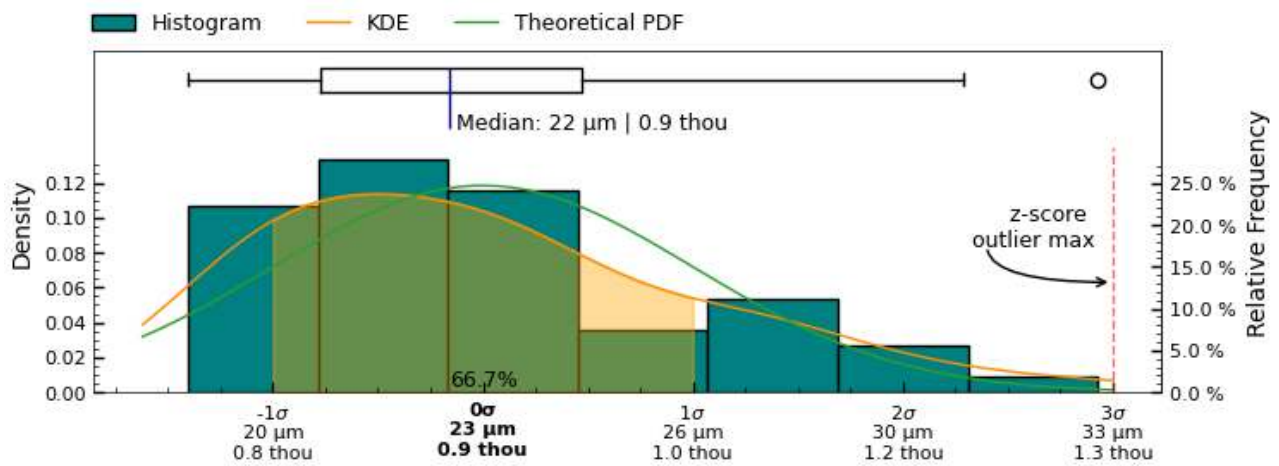


Figure 12: Range measurement distribution across measured slices of REF01 surface

Standard Deviation measurement distribution across 54 slices of REF01 surface

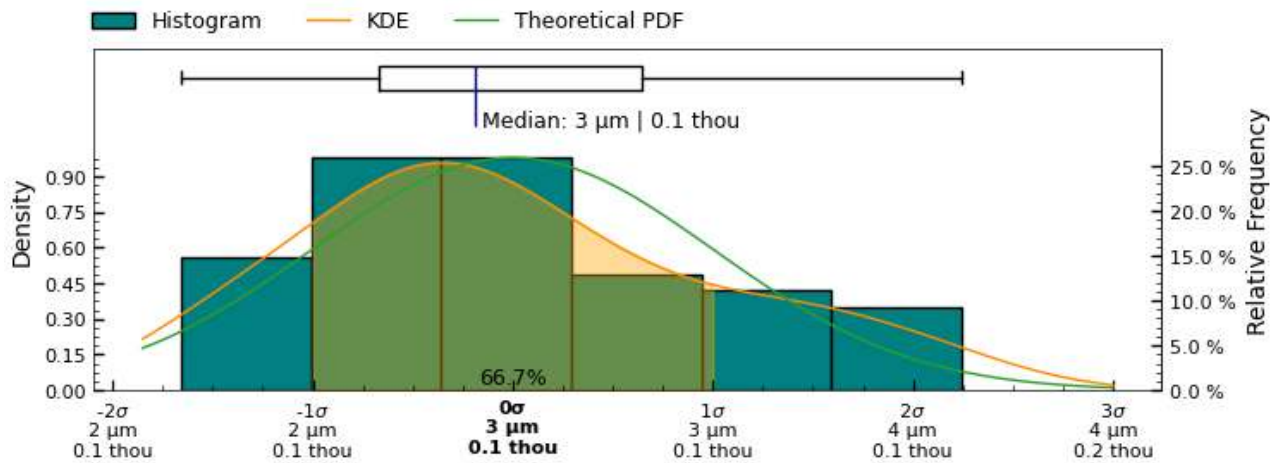


Figure 13: Standard Deviation measurement distribution across measured slices of " + REF01 + " surface

Root Mean Squared Deviation measurement distribution across 54 slices of REF01 surface

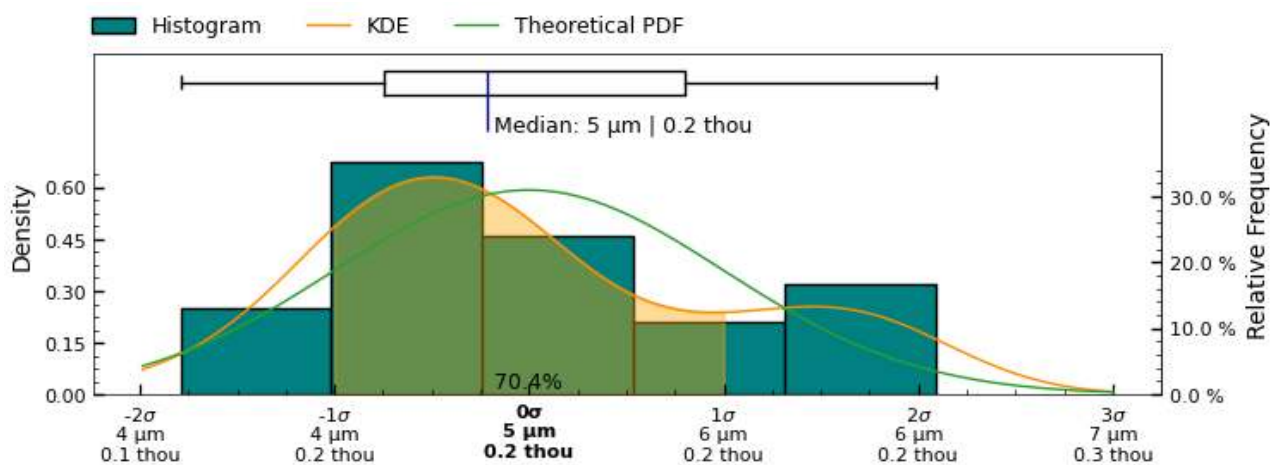


Figure 14: Root Mean Squared Deviation measurement distribution across measured slices of REF01 surface

Concentricity

The concentricity metric describes the deviation in the center-point of the referenced features. As such, it is a measure to determine if several features of the object share the same center point/axis, and how closely. See Figure 15 for a visual representation of this metric.

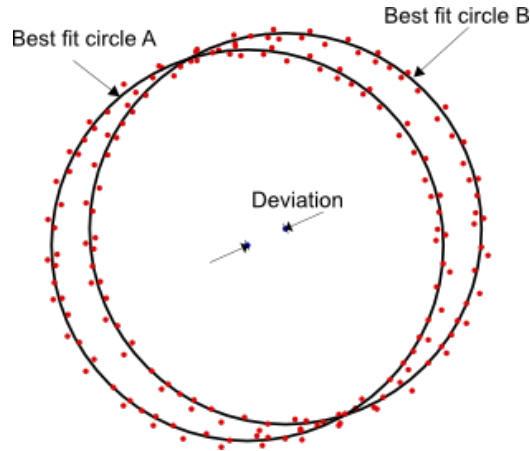


Figure 15: Concentricity measures the deviation (distance) between the center of two circles.

Determination of concentricity has been carried out by establishing the best fit circles of sample slices, using RANSAC (Random sample consensus) algorithm for outlier detection of a least squares circle regression on the scanned data-points at each cross-section, to estimate centers of each cross-section.

The concentricity between both the interior and exterior circular cross-sections is explored for cross-section measurements with the same Z-coordinates.

Additionally, the concentricity between each cross-section measurement defined in Figure 4 and the datum axis $(x, y) = (0, 0)$ has been calculated to establish the deviation of the feature center from the datum axis.

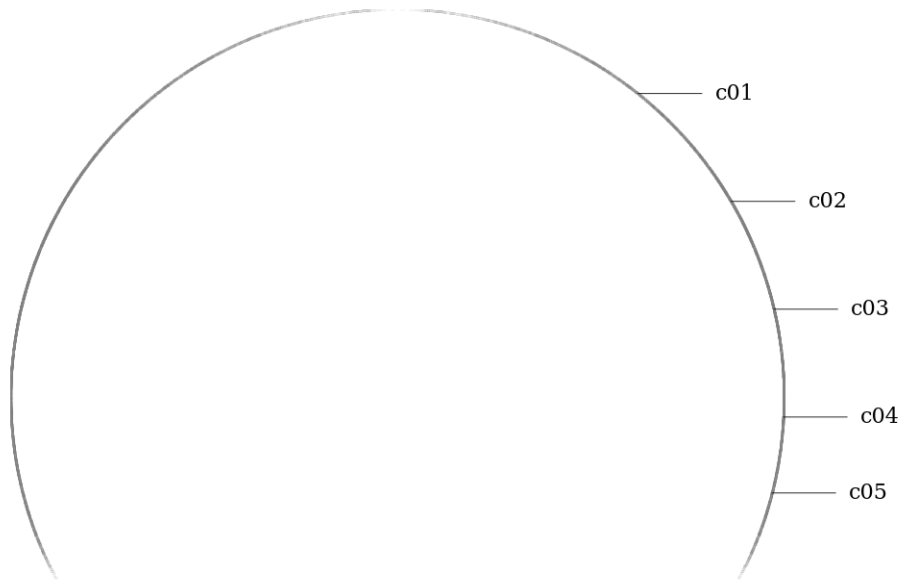


Figure 16: Circularity measurement sample locations,
full mesh aligned to exterior surface

Metric

Tag	Reference	Deviation	Sample size	Circle fit residuals analysis for sample listed in Tag column						Center (x,y)
				Range full	Range inliers	RMSD full	RMDS inliers	SD full	SD inliers	
				mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	
c01	z-axis	0.007	44	0.029	0.029	0.007	0.007	0.004	0.004	5, -4
c02	z-axis	0.002	121	0.016	0.016	0.004	0.004	0.003	0.003	-1, 2
c03	z-axis	0.001	157	0.021	0.021	0.004	0.004	0.003	0.003	-1, -1
c04	z-axis	0.002	139	0.024	0.024	0.005	0.005	0.003	0.003	-1, 1
c05	z-axis	0.006	116	0.037	0.037	0.009	0.009	0.005	0.005	-3, 6

Imperial

Tag	Reference	Deviation	Sample size	Circle fit residuals analysis for sample listed in Tag column						Center (x,y)
				Range full	Range inliers	RMSD full	RMDS inliers	SD full	SD inliers	
				in	in	in	in	in	in	
c01	z-axis	0.0003	44	0.0011	0.0011	0.0003	0.0003	0.0002	0.0002	0.2, -0.2
c02	z-axis	0.0001	121	0.0006	0.0006	0.0002	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	-0.0, 0.1
c03	z-axis	0.0001	157	0.0008	0.0008	0.0002	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	-0.0, -0.0
c04	z-axis	0.0001	139	0.0010	0.0010	0.0002	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	-0.0, 0.1
c05	z-axis	0.0003	116	0.0014	0.0014	0.0004	0.0004	0.0002	0.0002	-0.1, 0.2

Table 3: Concentricity analysis of REF01.

Concentricity analysis of c01

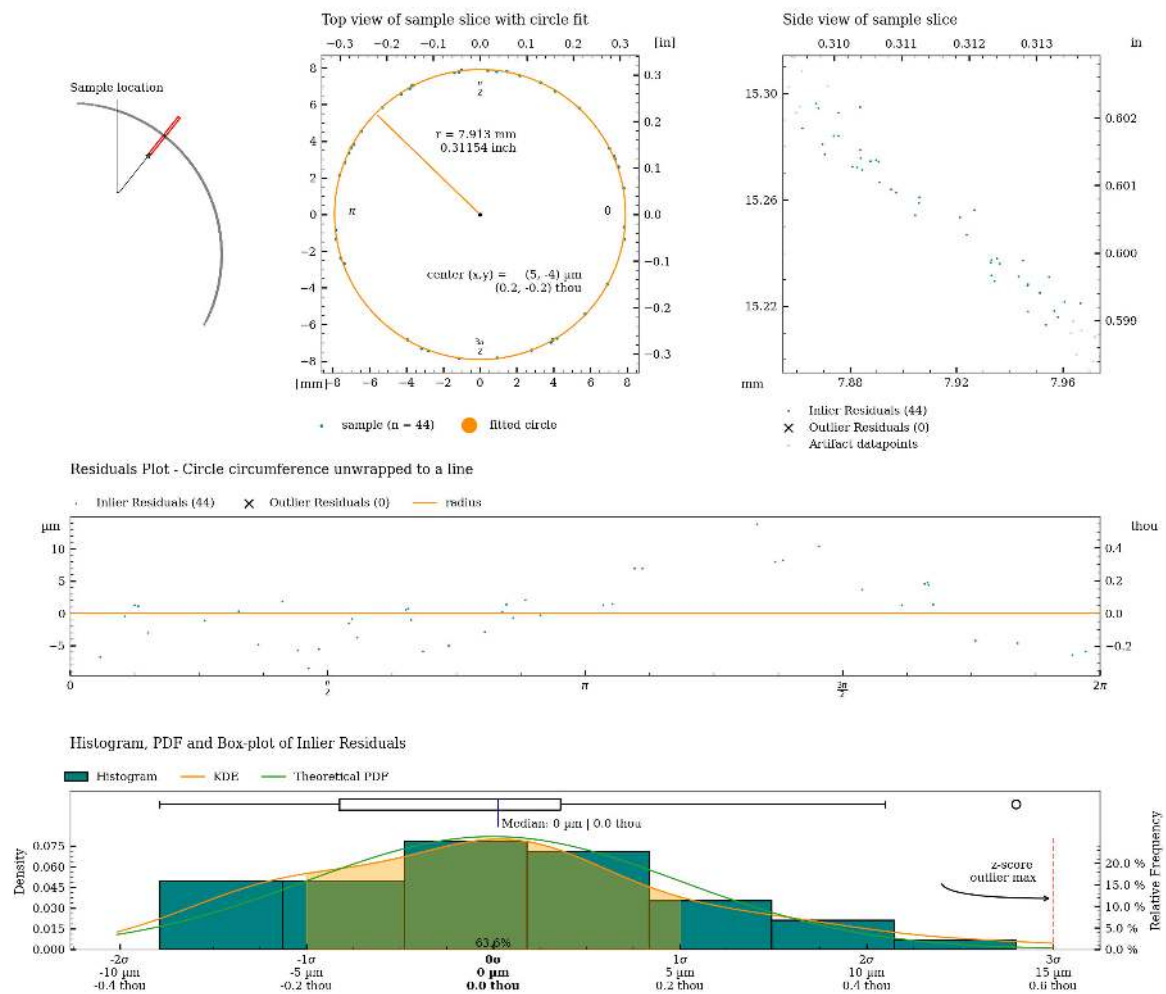


Figure 17: Detailed plot of concentricity measurement for c01.

Concentricity analysis of c02

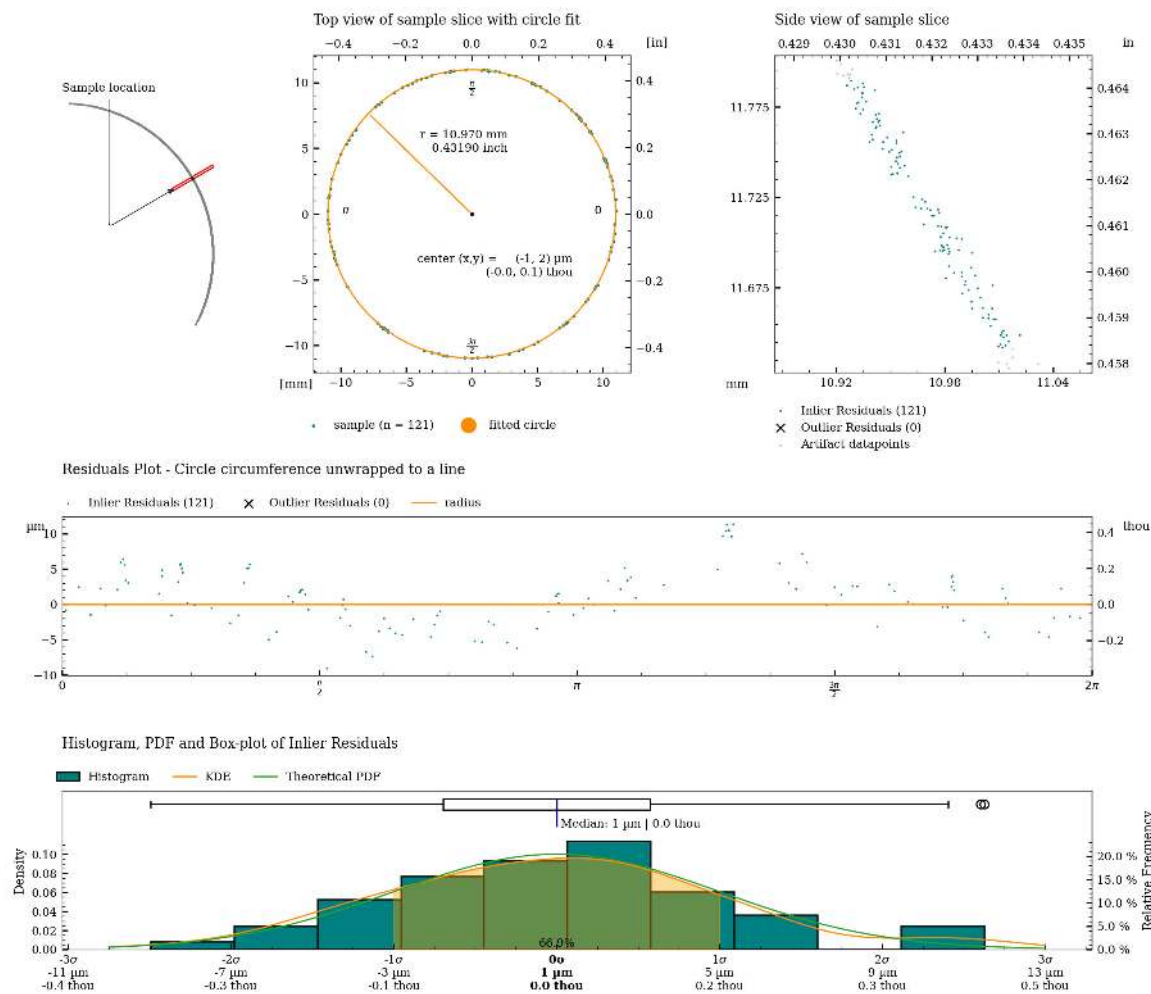


Figure 18: Detailed plot of concentricity measurement for c02.

Concentricity analysis of c03

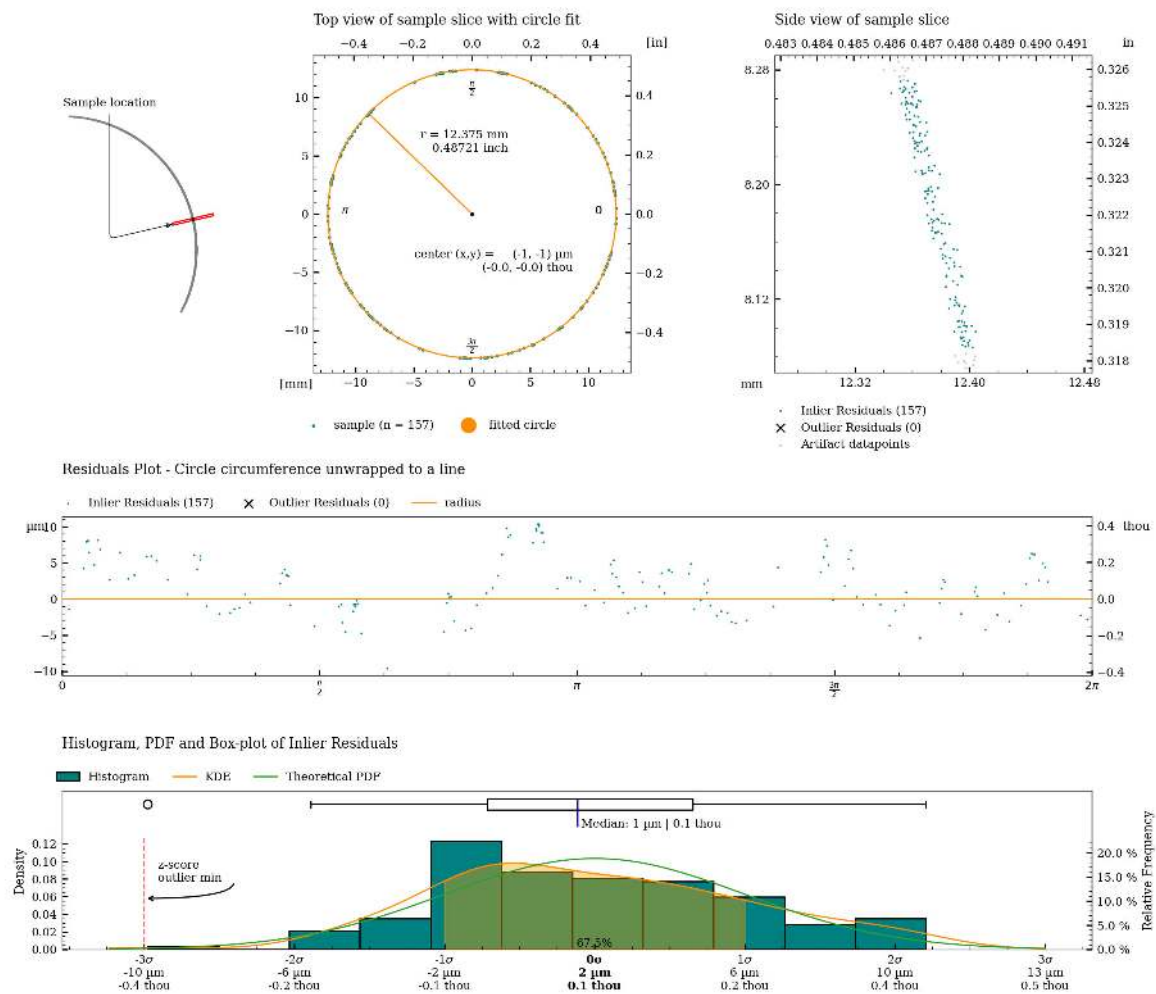


Figure 19: Detailed plot of concentricity measurement for c03.

Concentricity analysis of c04

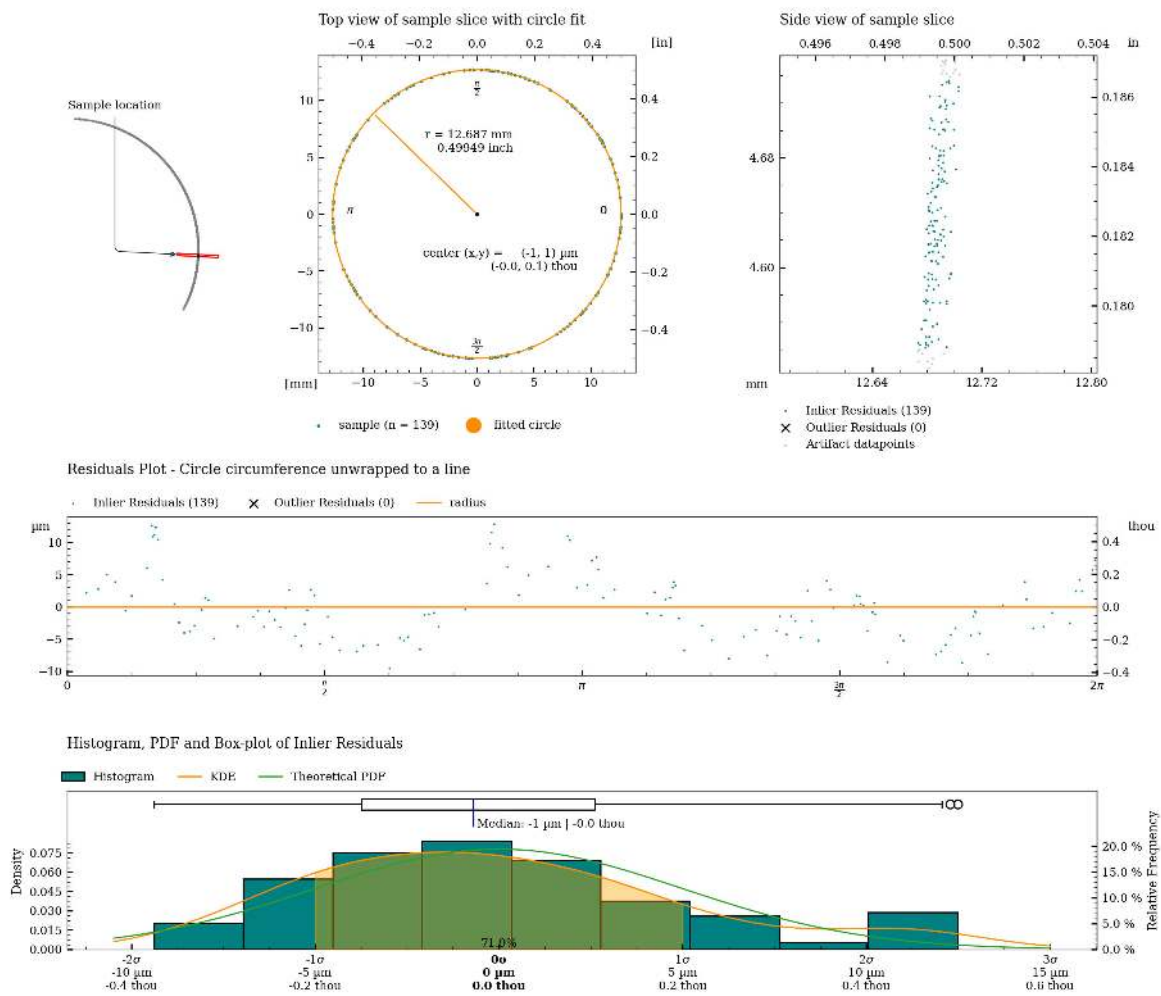


Figure 20: Detailed plot of concentricity measurement for c04.

Concentricity analysis of c05

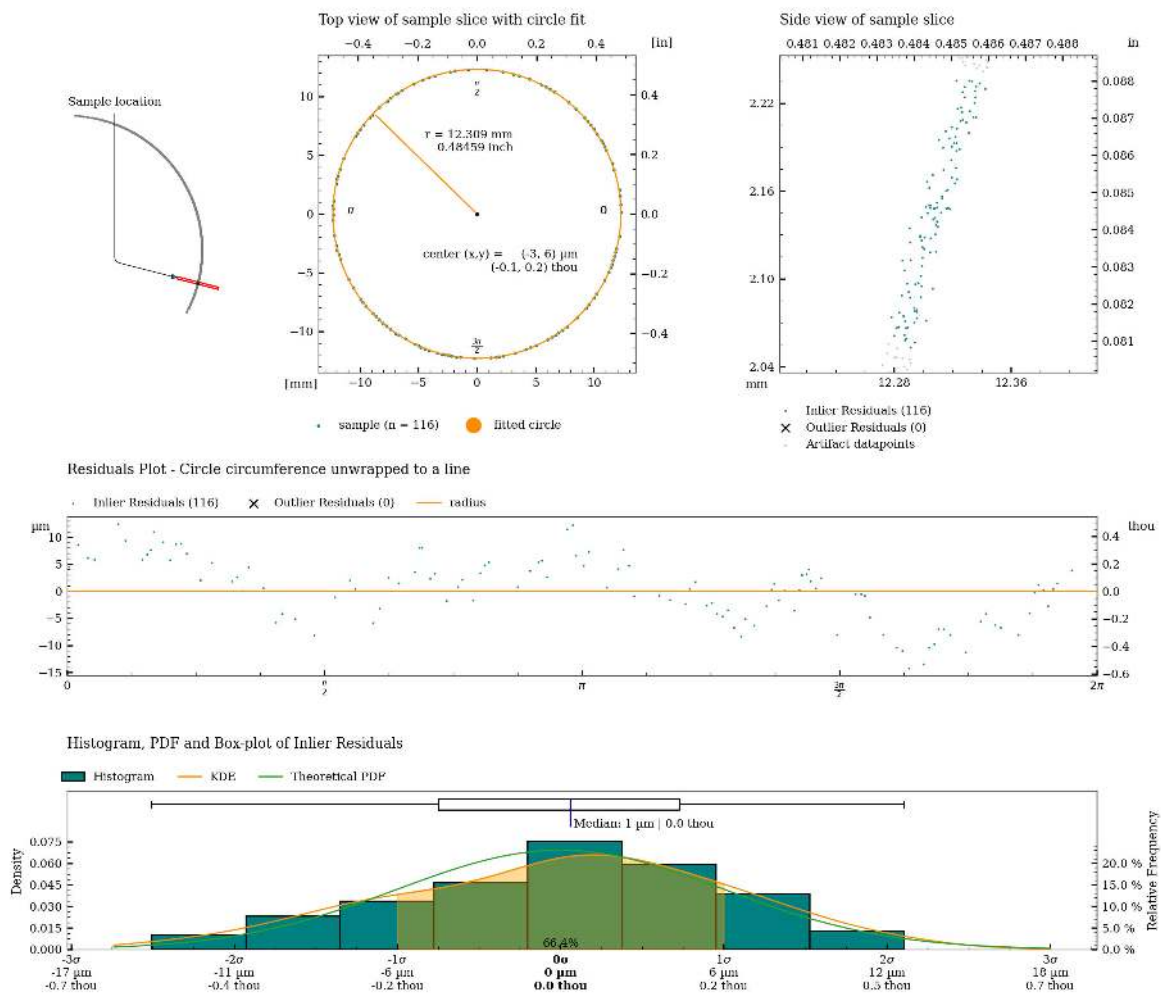


Figure 21: Detailed plot of concentricity measurement for c05.

Coaxiality

Coaxiality refers to the straightness and consistency of a central line running through the center of the vase. It measures how aligned the core of the vase remains along its vertical axis.

The coaxiality measurements are calculated using RANSAC (Random sample consensus) algorithm for outlier detection on least squares circle regression on cross-sections of the vessel (excluding potential handles), to estimate the best fit circle centers for each slice of the vessel. A best-fit line connects these centers, showing whether the vessels’s shape twists or remains straight. This concept helps describe the symmetry and structural uniformity in a visual and analytical way.

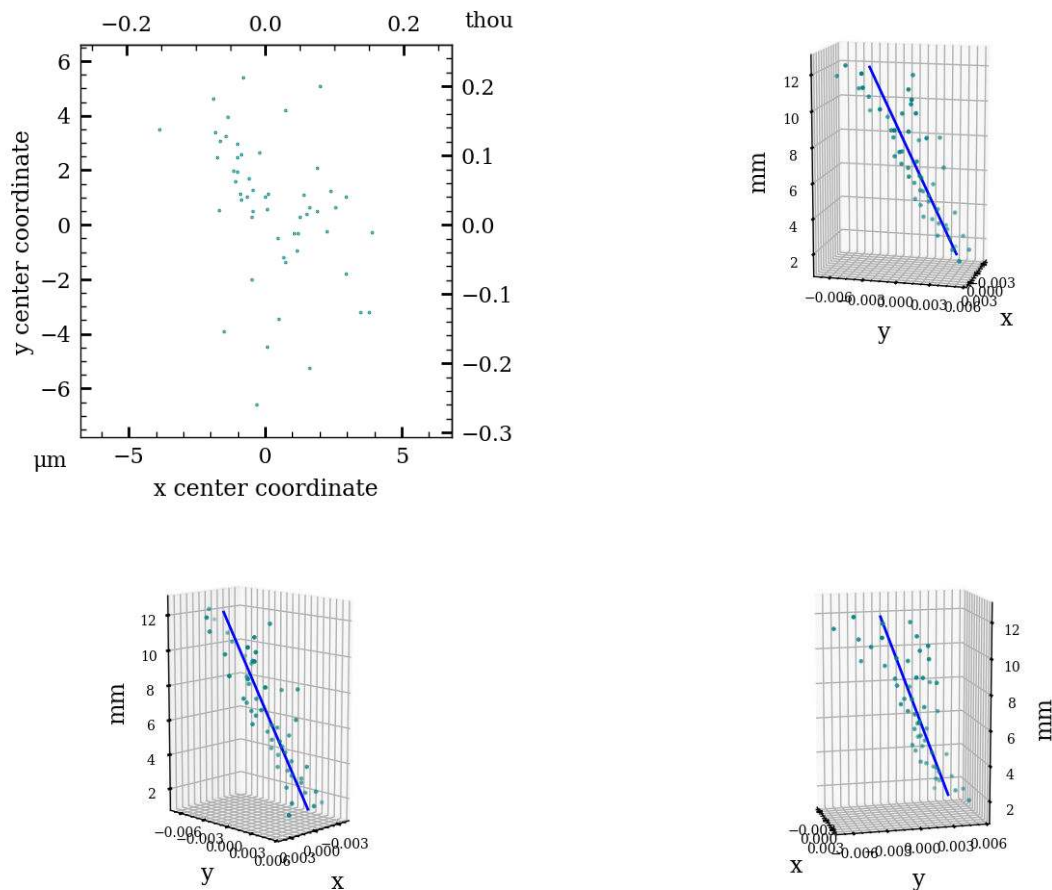
Coaxiality is measured for:

- The exterior surface (excluding handles)
- The interior surface

REF01					
Analyzed Slices				54	
Median sample size				128	
Slice Height		200 μm		7.9 thou	
Statistics with Z-axis as Reference					
Median Absolute Deviation (MAD)		2 μm		0.1 thou	
Standard Deviation (SD)		2 μm		0.1 thou	
Root Mean Square Deviation (RMSD)		3 μm		0.1 thou	
Statistics with Best Fit Central Axis as Reference					
Best fit Central Axis Equation (in metric coordinate system with unit [mm])		x = -0.002 + t0.00031 y = 0.005 + t-0.00066 z = 0.000 + t1.00000			
Axis tilt		0.018°			
Median Absolute Deviation (MAD)		2 μm		0.1 thou	
Standard Deviation (SD)		1 μm		0.0 thou	
Root Mean Square Deviation (RMSD)		2 μm		0.1 thou	

Table 4: Coaxiality analysis of vessel REF01.

Coaxiality plots, REF01 surface



Coaxiality residuals from fitted axis, REF01 surface

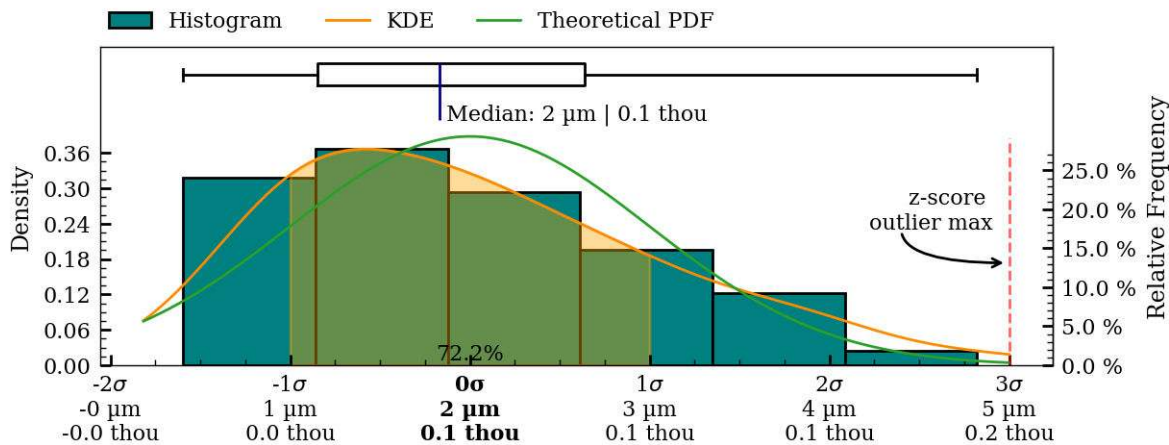


Figure 22: Coaxiality residual plots of REF01 surface, REF01.

Surface Variability

To illustrate the overall surface deviations of the object, a surface variability heatmap has been created. This heatmap provides an accessible overview of the topography of the manufacturing precision and surface structure of the object.

The surface variability measurements are created by fitting a number of higher-order polynomials to the two-dimensional folded profile of the scan data. This process creates an idealized mathematical representation of actual surface curvature of object, and as such provides a continuous model representation of the actual object. It is important to note that only such a non-discretized representation is sufficient to avoid introducing inconsistently varying errors in the mapping of the final surface deviation results, that the rendered heatmaps are based on.

To produce the final surface variability map, the distance from each scanned vertex to the fitted polynomial is calculated and used as the mapping function input, for applying colours to the surface of the object.

It is important to note that this variability map does not describe deviations from the original *intended* shape of the artifact (if any), as this shape (the *intended design*, so to speak) will have been lost to time. It does however provide a very informative visualization of the texture and structure of the surface and very importantly, *does* highlight potential manufacturing-relevant patterns in the surface texture (if present). Such patterns are, as an example, clearly evident on the interior surface of artifact PV001.

Exterior surface

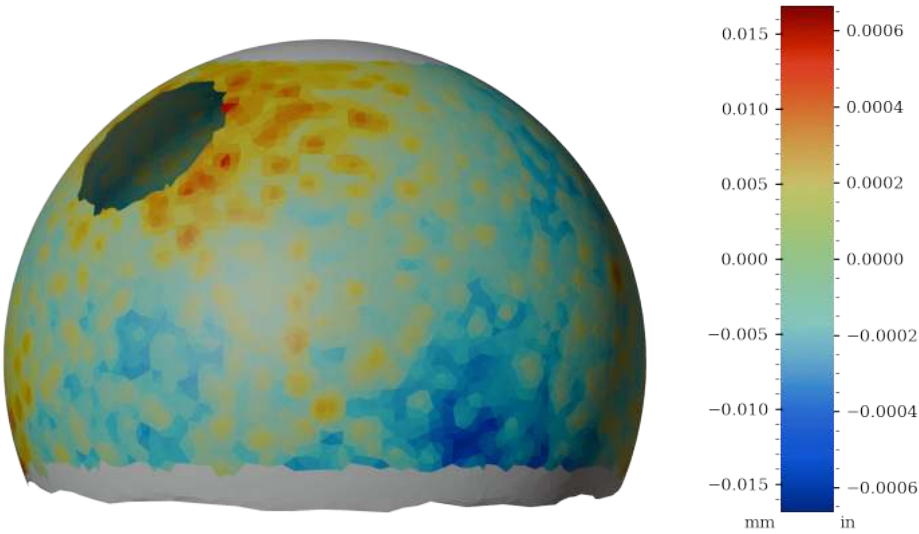


Figure 23: Surface variability heatmap of REF01, front view

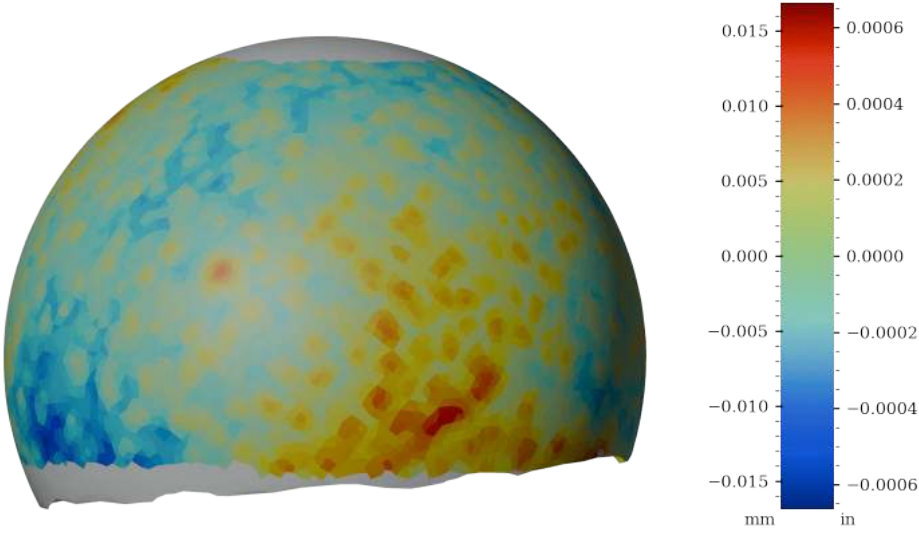


Figure 24: Surface variability heatmap of REF01, rotated 90°

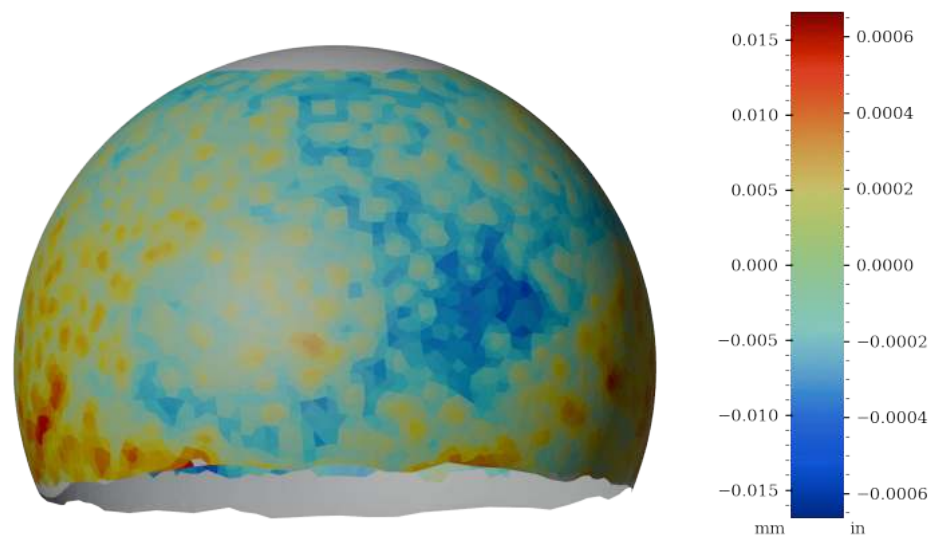


Figure 25: Surface variability heatmap of REF01, rotated 180°

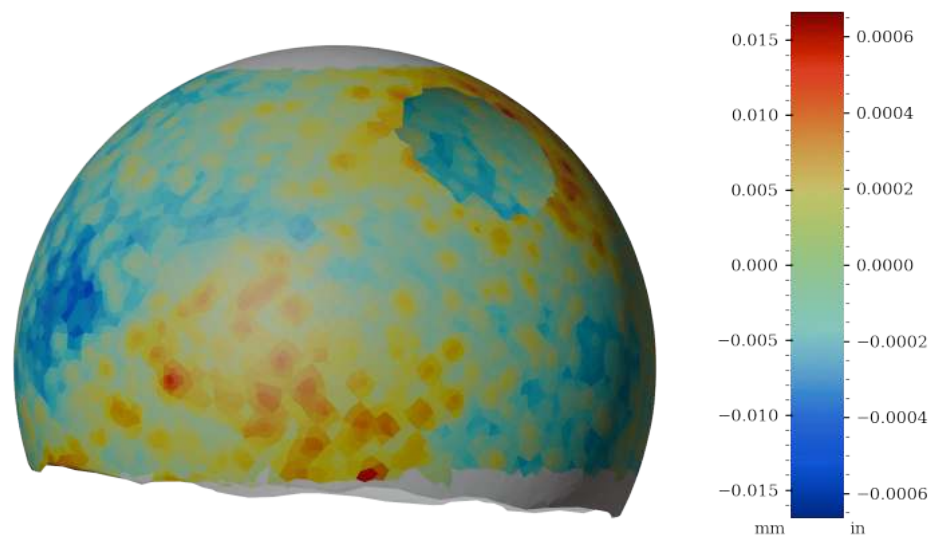


Figure 26: Surface variability heatmap of REF01, rotated 270°

Surface variability statistics

Area	MSD	RMSD	SD	Median AD	Range	Min	Max	Sample size
	mm ²	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	
REF01	0.0000	0.005	0.003	0.002	0.034	-0.017	0.017	11219
	in ²	in	in	in	in	in	in	
REF01	0.000000	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	0.0013	-0.0007	0.0007	11219

Table 5: Surface variability statistics, REF01

Table 5 shows the statistics of the distance from the scan vertices to the best fit object model. These statistics are briefly explained below.

Histogram, KDE and Box-plot of measured surface variability - exterior surface

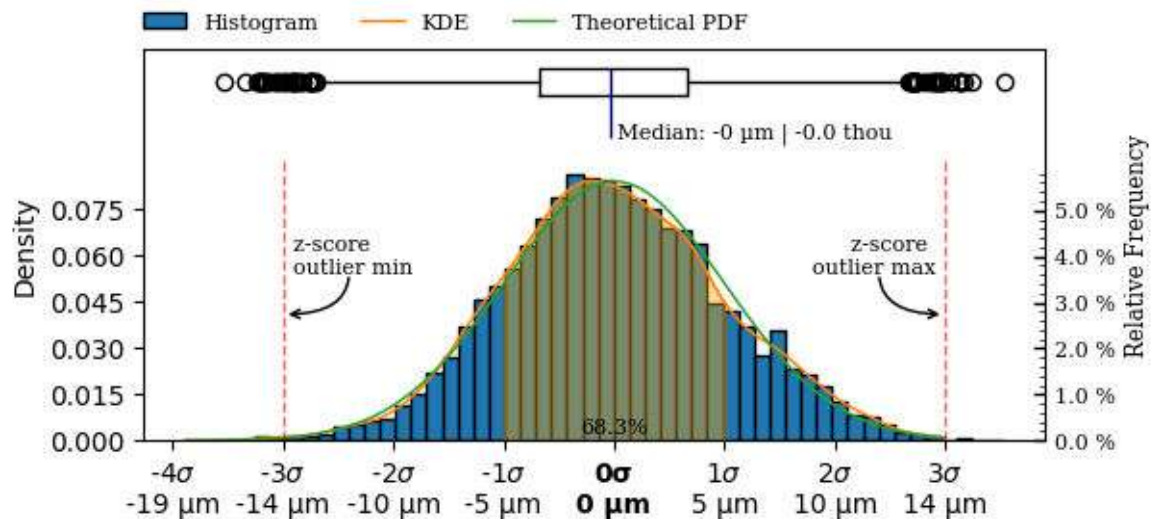


Figure 27: Exterior surface variability boxplot, kds and histogram.

Precision Score Of The Artifact

To enable valid comparison of the manufacturing precision of different artifacts, a metric that robustly quantifies the overall precision of the object is required. The considerations for such a metric will be explored in this section.

Based on these considerations, a *Precision Score* metric will be defined.

For an object to be described as having been manufactured with high precision, several qualities must be present *concurrently*, and throughout the *entire* geometry of the final object. A given object may exhibit high levels of one or more *components* of precision, but be lacking in others. For example:

- An object may present high levels of coaxiality, but lack circularity.
- An object may exhibit good circularity, but show imperfections in the surface structure.
- An object may be smoothed to perfection *without* any circularity or coaxiality.
- An object may exhibit high levels of all of the above metrics in *some* areas, but not in others.

Therefore, a precision score metric **must** account for *all* aspects of the individual, underlying precision metrics (circularity, concentricity, coaxiality and surface variability) throughout the *entire* surface area of the object.

The composite high order polynomial model, used to generate the surface variability map (described in Surface Variability, p. 28) is the best continuous mathematical representation of the object available to us (lacking any original design plans, as would normally be available in metrological analysis). This idealized model encompasses all of the above component metrics.

In the creation of the model, all scan data-points are taken into account (excluding areas with extensive damage), making it the best possible idealized representation we can achieve. When this model has been accurately created, the deviation between the model and the scanned data-points can be calculated over the non-discretized polynomials, *without* the need for an “original” CAD model (and importantly, unless such a CAD model *actually* corresponded to the original design intent, it would be an insufficient comparison basis).

Within the context of defining a valid, overall precision metric, this approach satisfies the incorporation of all of the necessary metrics:

- **Circularity:** Because the reconstructed polynomial model is revolved around the Z-plane, the idealized representation is perfectly circular, and thus incorporates the circularity component.
- **Concentricity and coaxiality:** Because the Z-axis (datum axis) is the center axis of the model, it incorporates the concentricity and coaxiality components.
- **Surface variability:** Because the model is continuous and non-discretized, it can be used accurately for all points of the scan data, and incorporates the surface variability component.

The level of precision ultimately achieved in a physical object does not share a linear relationship with its manufacturing requirements. Since continuously higher levels of final precision becomes progressively harder to achieve, an overall precision metric must take this relationship into account.

A robust statistical metric that satisfies this requirement is the *Mean Squared Deviation* (MSD or MSE). Here specifically, we can utilize the mean square of the deviations between the model ($\hat{y}$) and the data-points (y_i).

Combining all of the above considerations, we can express a well-defined *Precision Score* metric, that provides an immediately accessible way to understand the overall precision of an object, while being statistically valid. Since the Mean Squared Deviation tends towards zero as the overall precision increases, the inverse of the Mean Squared Deviation is taken to obtain a precision score metric that increases as precision increases¹²:

$$\text{Precision Score} = \frac{n}{\sum_{i=1}^n (y_i - \hat{y})^2}$$

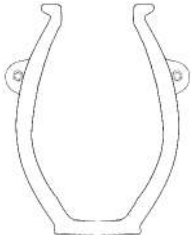
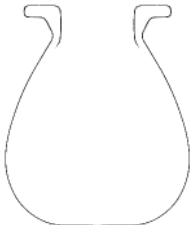
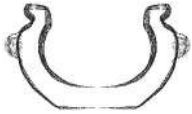
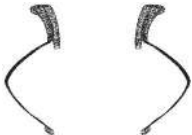
¹²The precision score unit is $\frac{1}{\text{mm}^2}$

The precision score of REF01 have been calculated separately for:

- Precision score, exterior surface: 43943

The precision score of a Zeiss 1.00000 inch reference sphere have been calculated to 43,943 (RMSE = 0.00477 mm / 0.00010 in). The scan was obtained by Max Fomitchev-Zamilov using a Keyence VL –500 scanner with a rated accuracy of 10 microns. The precision analysis of the reference sphere scan indicates at the maximum possible precision score obtainable.

Table 6 shows the precision score of this artifact (REF01), compared to the two most precise, and the two least precise vessels currently analyzed.

Artifact		Material	Precision Score	Link to Report
		REF01	43943 Full: 43943 Exterior: 43943	Report Publication
		PV001 Red Granite	1980 Full: 1177 Exterior: 1980 Interior separate: 798 Interior: 722	Report Publication
		PV006 Dark grey granite	621 Full: 610 Exterior: 621 Interior separate: 479 Interior: 152	Report Publication
		RV003 Marble breccia	1.46 Full: 1.49 Exterior: 1.46 Interior separate: 1.53 Interior: 0.54	Report Publication
		MV010 Calcite (Egyptian Alabaster)	1.17 Full: 1.32 Exterior: 1.17 Interior separate: 11 Interior: 0.17	Report Publication

Analysis Roadmap

While the current iteration of this work already provides valuable results, continued future additions and improvements will enhance their utility further. This section details planned iterative updates and improvements, to both the reports themselves, and to the underlying methodology and software they are created with.

Alignment Section

- Detailed exploration of different circle regression algorithms
- If handles are present on the vessel, exploring alignment of the vessels so the handle positions match each other
- Add optimization of the perpendicular surface deviation, with the best results of the coaxial alignment
- Align by minimizing circularity results (of rotated sample slice, to compensate for sample height distortions)

Measurements of Precision

- Section detailing how measurements perpendicular to the surface curvature are obtained
- Detailed surface area analysis, exploring the residual patterns throughout subsequent sample slices of the artifact surface
- Wall thickness deviation color map
- Robust outlier identification on circularity, to better handle analysis of damaged areas of the artifacts in addition to removal of interior crystalline structure points present in CT scans
- Layout updates to the charts and tables

Visibility of Outliers and Damaged Sections

- Identification and marking of damaged parts
- Visualization of outliers on the artifact surface

Exploration of Mathematical Primitives

- Analysis of selected curvatures and flat surfaces on the vessel in both the horizontal and vertical planes
 - Circles
 - Parabolas
 - Ellipsoids
 - Hyperbolas
 - Cones
- Implementation of robust regressions models suitable for this domain, based on RANSAC.

Metrics on Primary Features

- Measurements of features in the horizontal plane
- Measurements of features in the vertical plane
- Measurements of angles
- Measurements of volume

Exploration of Potential Design Ratios

- π , φ , e , 1, 2, 3, 4 etc.

Raw Dataset Attachments

- Including all measurement and sample coordinates as CSV-files embedded in the report
- Including an STL file of the aligned object alongside the report, for easier external replication and validation of the research results

Appendix A - Comparison Of Circularity Measurements (Z-plane vs. surface-perpendicular)

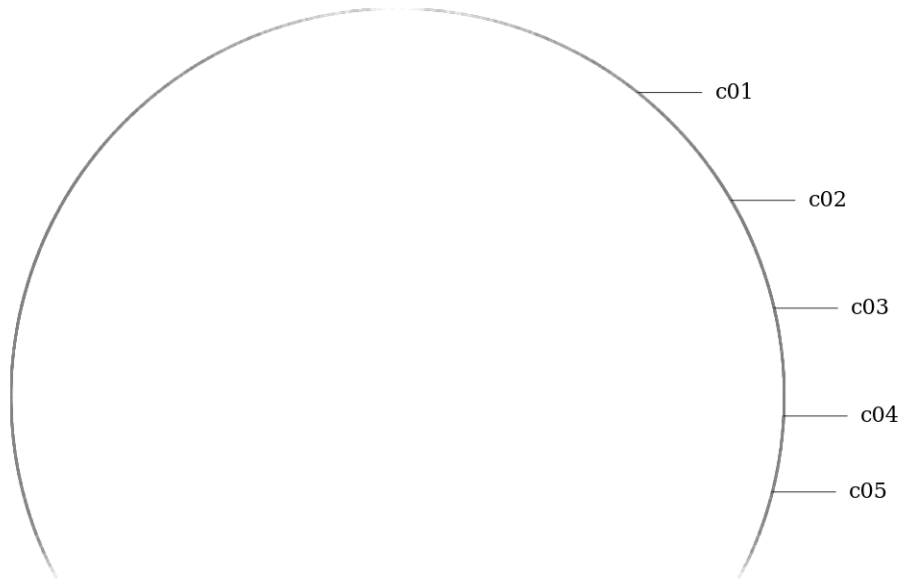


Figure 28: Circularity measurement sample locations, full mesh aligned to exterior surface

Samples perpendicular to the surface curvature

Tag	Area	Measured deviation ⁸	Residuals				Sample size	Slice		
			Range	RMSD ⁹	MAD ¹⁰	SD		Height	Z coord.	Radius ¹¹
		mm	mm	mm	mm	mm		mm	mm	mm
c01	full	$\text{Ø}15.826 \pm 0.014$	0.022	0.005	0.002	0.003	44	0.200	15.254	7.913
c02	full	$\text{Ø}21.944 \pm 0.010$	0.020	0.004	0.002	0.002	121	0.200	11.716	10.972
c03	full	$\text{Ø}24.753 \pm 0.011$	0.020	0.004	0.001	0.002	157	0.200	8.178	12.376
c04	full	$\text{Ø}25.374 \pm 0.013$	0.022	0.005	0.002	0.003	139	0.200	4.640	12.687
c05	full	$\text{Ø}24.619 \pm 0.015$	0.027	0.006	0.003	0.004	116	0.200	2.148	12.310

Table 7: Detailed circularity measurements at selected samples in z-plane, vessel REF01.

Samples in the Z-plane

Tag	Area	Measured deviation ⁸	Residuals				Sample size	Slice		
			Range	RMSD ⁹	MAD ¹⁰	SD		Height	Z coord.	Radius ¹¹
		mm	mm	mm	mm	mm		mm	mm	mm
c01	full	$\text{Ø}15.812 \pm 0.132$	0.251	0.073	0.026	0.033	126	0.200	15.254	7.906
c02	full	$\text{Ø}21.941 \pm 0.070$	0.133	0.033	0.013	0.016	151	0.200	11.716	10.970
c03	full	$\text{Ø}24.747 \pm 0.031$	0.059	0.015	0.006	0.008	164	0.200	8.178	12.373
c04	full	$\text{Ø}25.373 \pm 0.016$	0.029	0.006	0.002	0.004	141	0.200	4.640	12.687
c05	full	$\text{Ø}24.616 \pm 0.035$	0.068	0.017	0.007	0.009	125	0.200	2.148	12.308

Table 8: Detailed circularity measurements at selected samples perpendicular to vessel curvature, vessel REF01.

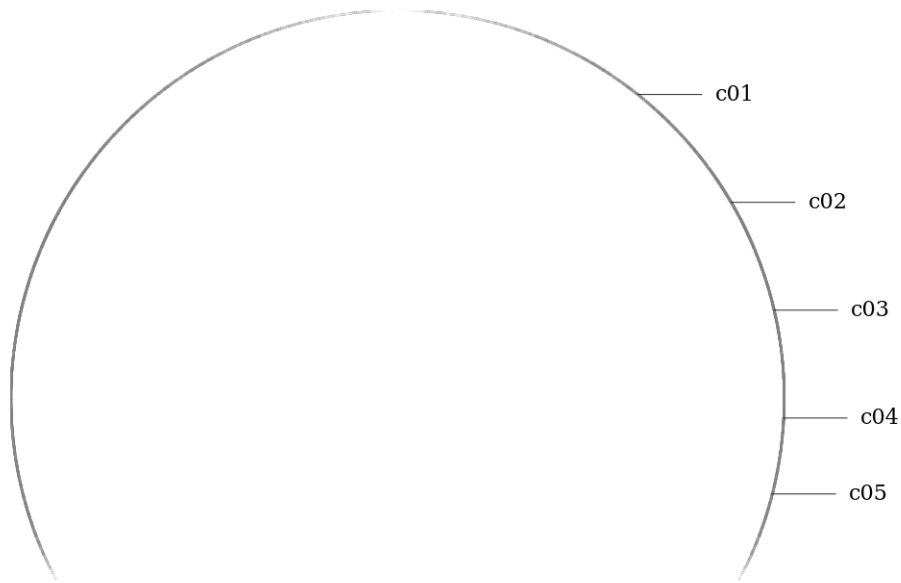


Figure 29: Circularity measurement sample locations, full mesh aligned to exterior surface

Samples perpendicular to the surface curvature

Tag	Area	Measured deviation ⁸	Residuals				Sample size	Slice		
			Range	RMSD ⁹	MAD ¹⁰	SD		Height	Z coord.	Radius ¹¹
		in	in	in	in	in		in	in	in
c01	full	$\emptyset 0.6231 \pm 0.0006$	0.0009	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	44	0.0079	0.6005	0.3115
c02	full	$\emptyset 0.8639 \pm 0.0004$	0.0008	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	121	0.0079	0.4613	0.4320
c03	full	$\emptyset 0.9745 \pm 0.0004$	0.0008	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	157	0.0079	0.3220	0.4873
c04	full	$\emptyset 0.9990 \pm 0.0005$	0.0009	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	139	0.0079	0.1827	0.4995
c05	full	$\emptyset 0.9693 \pm 0.0006$	0.0010	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	116	0.0079	0.0846	0.4846

Table 9: Detailed circularity measurements at selected samples in z-plane, vessel REF01.

Samples in the Z-plane

Tag	Area	Measured deviation ⁸	Residuals				Sample size	Slice		
			Range	RMSD ⁹	MAD ¹⁰	SD		Height	Z coord.	Radius ¹¹
		in	in	in	in	in		in	in	in
c01	full	$\emptyset 0.6225 \pm 0.0052$	0.0099	0.0029	0.0010	0.0013	126	0.0079	0.6005	0.3113
c02	full	$\emptyset 0.8638 \pm 0.0028$	0.0052	0.0013	0.0005	0.0006	151	0.0079	0.4613	0.4319
c03	full	$\emptyset 0.9743 \pm 0.0012$	0.0023	0.0006	0.0002	0.0003	164	0.0079	0.3220	0.4871
c04	full	$\emptyset 0.9989 \pm 0.0006$	0.0012	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	141	0.0079	0.1827	0.4995
c05	full	$\emptyset 0.9691 \pm 0.0014$	0.0027	0.0007	0.0003	0.0004	125	0.0079	0.0846	0.4846

Table 10: Detailed circularity measurements at selected samples perpendicular to vessel curvature, vessel REF01.

Comparison of circularity on the full vessel surface

Metric

Samples perpendicular to the surface curvature

Area	Range			Standard Deviation			RMSD			Slices	Slice height
	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.		
	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm		mm
REF01	0.022	0.018	0.033	0.003	0.002	0.004	0.005	0.004	0.006	54	0.200

Table 11: Detailed circularity measurements at selected samples in z-plane, vessel REF01.

Samples in the z-plane

Area	Range			Standard Deviation			RMSD			Slices	Slice height
	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.		
	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm		mm
REF01	0.078	0.020	0.426	0.011	0.002	0.061	0.021	0.005	0.118	79	0.200

Table 12: Detailed circularity measurements at selected samples perpendicular to vessel curvature, vessel REF01.

Imperial

Samples perpendicular to the surface curvature

Area	Range			Standard Deviation			RMSD			Slices	Slice height
	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.		
	in	in	in	in	in	in	in	in	in		in
REF01	0.022	0.018	0.033	0.003	0.002	0.004	0.005	0.004	0.006	54	0.200

Table 13: Detailed circularity measurements at selected samples in z-plane, vessel REF01.

Samples in the z-plane

Area	Range			Standard Deviation			RMSD			Slices	Slice height
	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.	Median	Min.	Max.		
	in	in	in	in	in	in	in	in	in		in
REF01	0.078	0.020	0.426	0.011	0.002	0.061	0.021	0.005	0.118	79	0.200

Table 14: Detailed circularity measurements at selected samples perpendicular to vessel curvature, vessel REF01.

Circularity analysis of REF01 surface - perpendicular to surface curvature

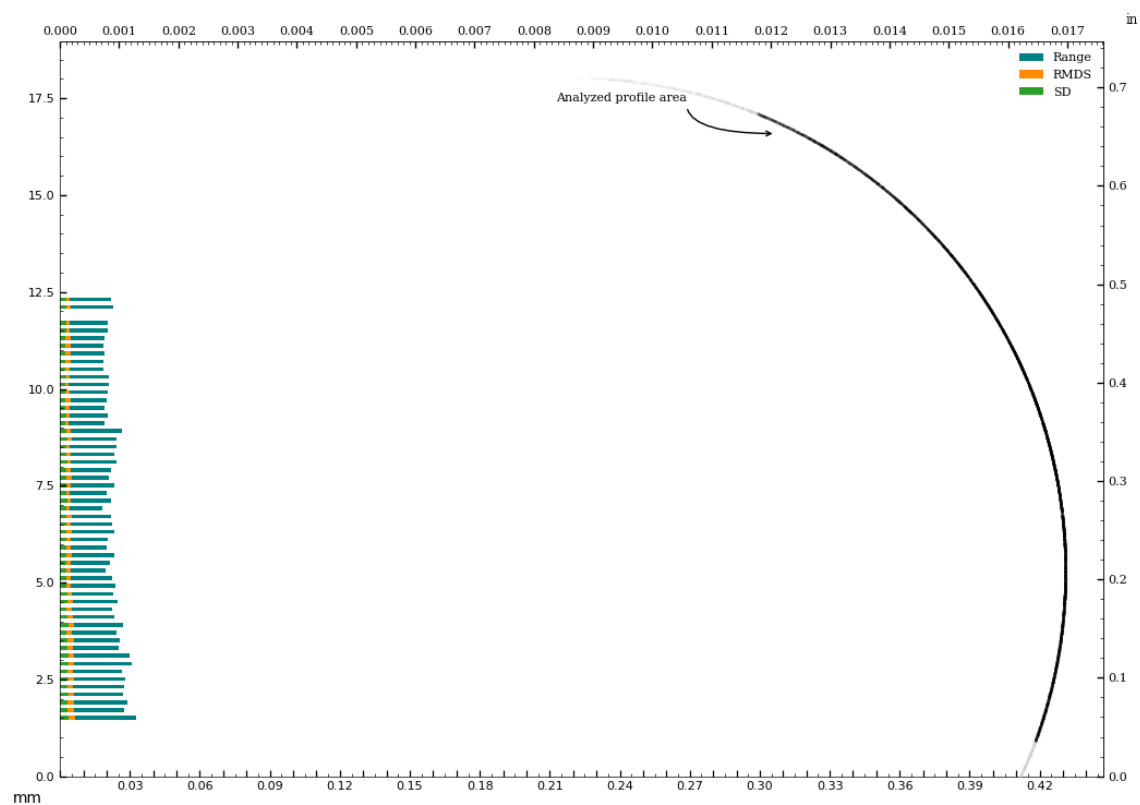


Figure 30: Circularity of REF01 surface - perpendicular to surface curvature.

Circularity analysis of REF01 surface - in z-plane

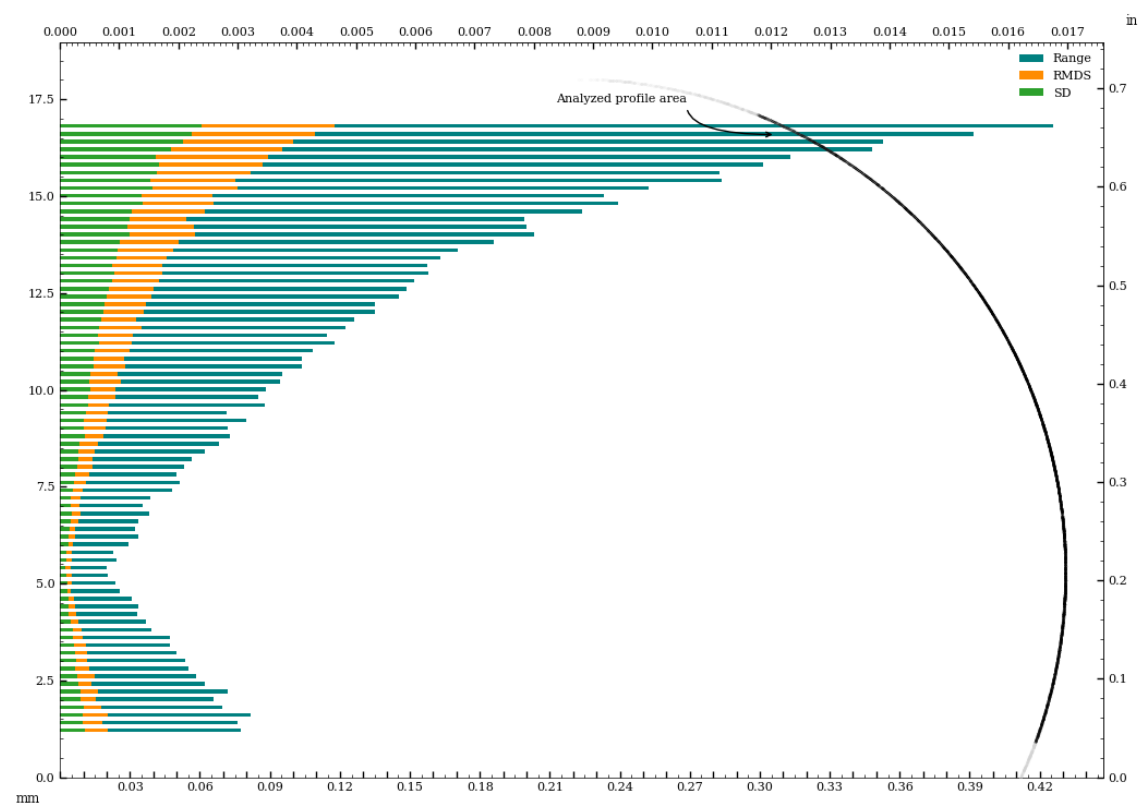


Figure 31: Circularity of REF01 surface - in z-plane.

Circularity analysis of REF01 surface, perpendicular to surface curvature, Standard Deviation and Root Mean Squared Deviation

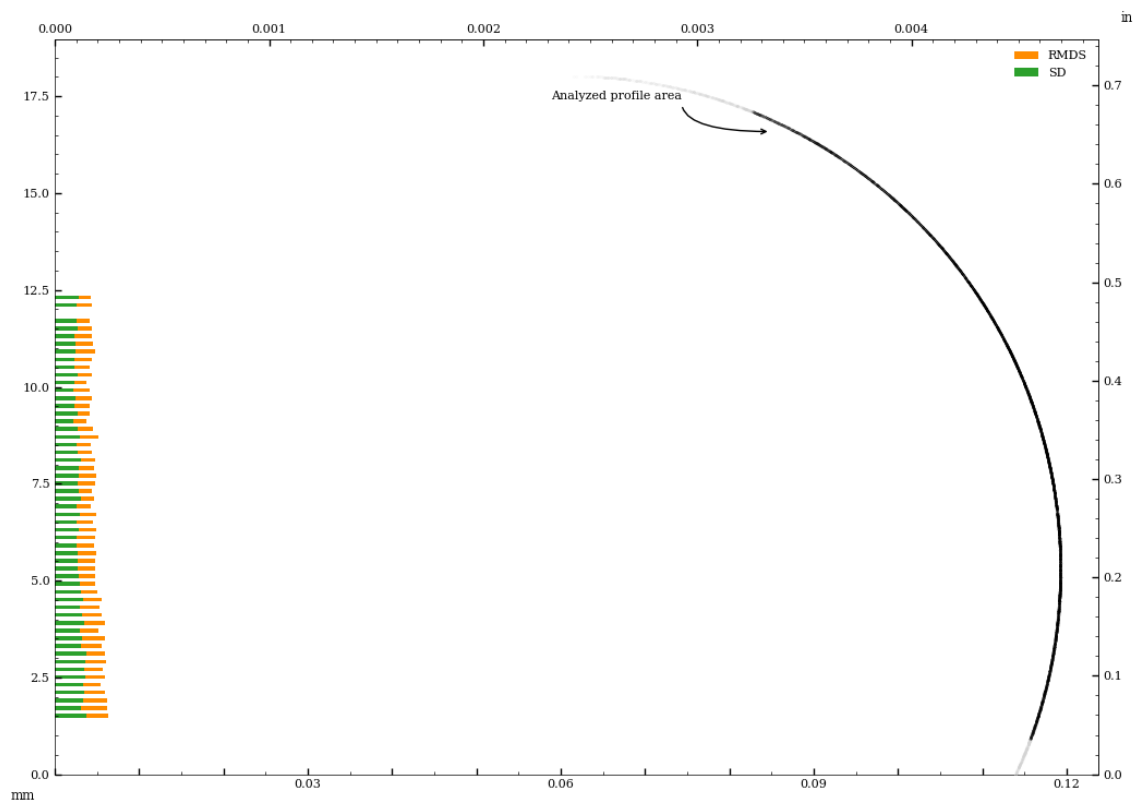


Figure 32: Vessel circularity of REF01 surface, perpendicular to surface curvature, standard deviation and median absolute deviation.

Circularity analysis of REF01 surface, in z-plane, Standard Deviation and Root Mean Squared Deviation

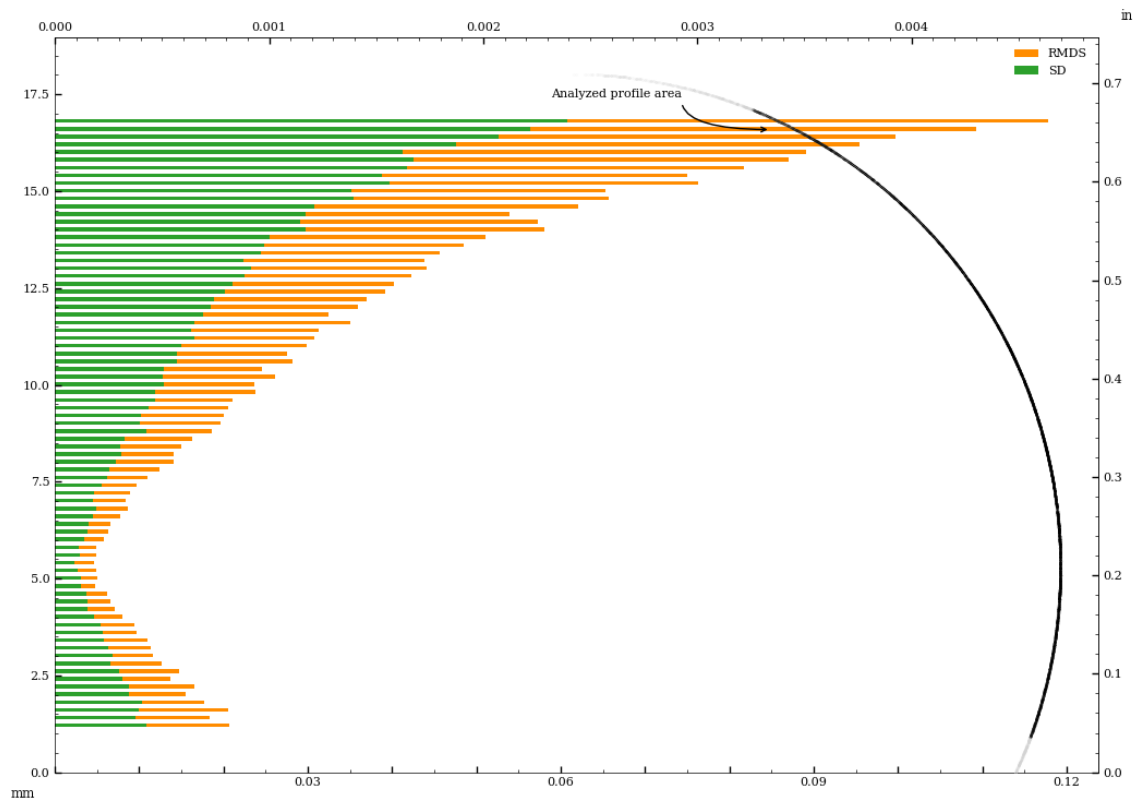


Figure 33: Vessel circularity of REF01 surface, in z-plane, standard deviation and median absolute deviation.

Appendix B - Comparison Of Concentricity Measurements (Z-plane vs. surface-perpendicular)

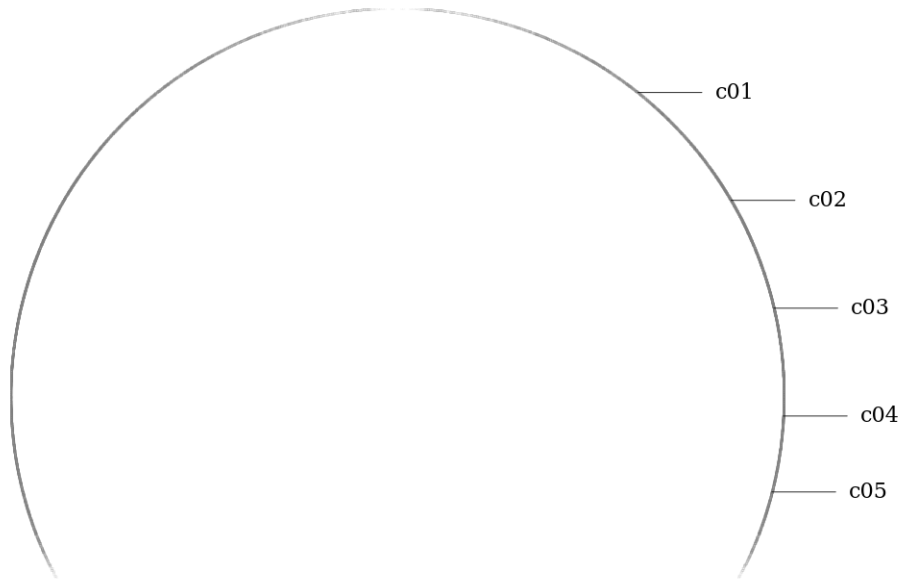


Figure 34: Circularity measurement sample locations, full mesh aligned to exterior surface

Concentricity measurements perpendicular to surface curvature

Tag	Reference	Deviation	Sample size	Circle fit residuals analysis for sample listed in Tag column						Center (x,y)
				Range full	Range inliers	RMSD full	RMDS inliers	SD full	SD inliers	
		mm		mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	μm
c01	z-axis	0.007	126	0.257	0.257	0.073	0.073	0.033	0.033	6, -4
c02	z-axis	0.004	151	0.129	0.129	0.033	0.033	0.016	0.016	-1, 3
c03	z-axis	0.001	164	0.059	0.059	0.015	0.015	0.007	0.007	-1, -0
c04	z-axis	0.002	141	0.032	0.032	0.006	0.006	0.004	0.004	-1, 1
c05	z-axis	0.007	125	0.083	0.083	0.019	0.019	0.011	0.011	-2, 7

Concentricity measurements in z-plane

Tag	Reference	Deviation	Sample size	Circle fit residuals analysis for sample listed in Tag column						Center (x,y)
				Range full	Range inliers	RMSD full	RMDS inliers	SD full	SD inliers	
		mm		mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	mm	μm
c01	z-axis	0.007	126	0.257	0.257	0.073	0.073	0.033	0.033	6, -4
c02	z-axis	0.004	151	0.129	0.129	0.033	0.033	0.016	0.016	-1, 3
c03	z-axis	0.001	164	0.059	0.059	0.015	0.015	0.007	0.007	-1, -0
c04	z-axis	0.002	141	0.032	0.032	0.006	0.006	0.004	0.004	-1, 1
c05	z-axis	0.007	125	0.083	0.083	0.019	0.019	0.011	0.011	-2, 7

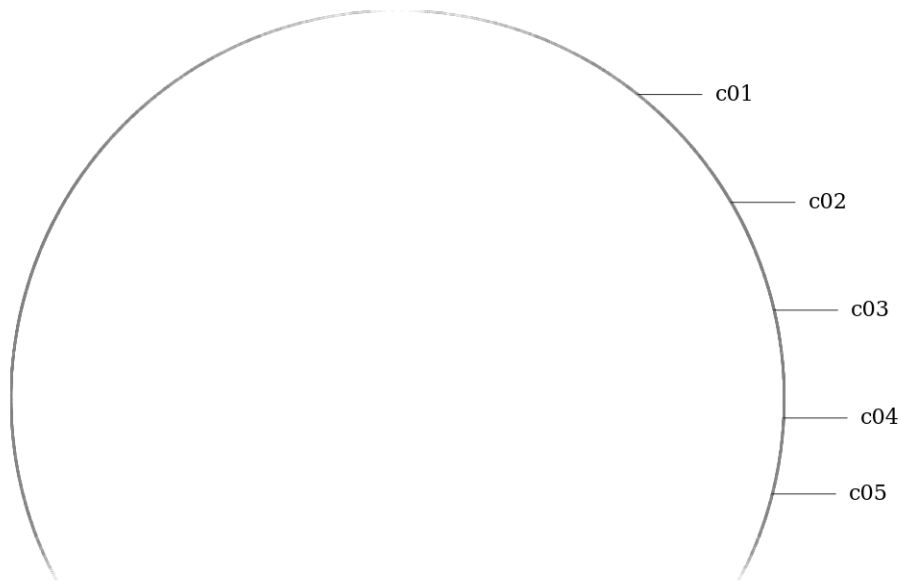


Figure 35: Circularity measurement sample locations, full mesh aligned to exterior surface

Concentricity measurements perpendicular to surface curvature

Tag	Reference	Deviation	Sample size	Circle fit residuals analysis for sample listed in Tag column						
				Range full	Range inliers	RMSD full	RMDS inliers	SD full	SD inliers	Center (x,y)
		in		in	in	in	in	in	in	thou
c01	z-axis	0.0003	126	0.0101	0.0101	0.0029	0.0029	0.0013	0.0013	0.2, -0.1
c02	z-axis	0.0001	151	0.0051	0.0051	0.0013	0.0013	0.0006	0.0006	-0.1, 0.1
c03	z-axis	0.0000	164	0.0023	0.0023	0.0006	0.0006	0.0003	0.0003	-0.0, -0.0
c04	z-axis	0.0001	141	0.0013	0.0013	0.0002	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	-0.0, 0.0
c05	z-axis	0.0003	125	0.0033	0.0033	0.0008	0.0008	0.0004	0.0004	-0.1, 0.3

Concentricity measurements in z-plane

Tag	Reference	Deviation	Sample size	Circle fit residuals analysis for sample listed in Tag column						
				Range full	Range inliers	RMSD full	RMDS inliers	SD full	SD inliers	Center (x,y)
		in		in	in	in	in	in	in	thou
c01	z-axis	0.0003	126	0.0101	0.0101	0.0029	0.0029	0.0013	0.0013	0.2, -0.1
c02	z-axis	0.0001	151	0.0051	0.0051	0.0013	0.0013	0.0006	0.0006	-0.1, 0.1
c03	z-axis	0.0000	164	0.0023	0.0023	0.0006	0.0006	0.0003	0.0003	-0.0, -0.0
c04	z-axis	0.0001	141	0.0013	0.0013	0.0002	0.0002	0.0001	0.0001	-0.0, 0.0
c05	z-axis	0.0003	125	0.0033	0.0033	0.0008	0.0008	0.0004	0.0004	-0.1, 0.3